GREYBORN

Maps & Monsters Design Bible

Maps · Creatures · Ascendants · Structures · World systems

Compiled from gdd/, spec/ and the playable build · October 2026

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Greyborn — Maps & Monsters Design Bible

A production-level reference for every map, creature, Ascendant and structure in Greyborn. It pulls together what is spread across the design document (`gdd/`), the build spec (`spec/`) and the playable build (`game/`). It also adds the detail that level designers, character artists, animators, VFX and audio need to start building.

How to read this document

Part	File	Contents
1	`01-standards.md`	Units, scale, stat-block format, telegraph rules, LOD and budgets, naming
2	`02-ascendants.md`	The Kith Base Form and all seven lineages, Stage by Stage: anatomy, numbers, kit, animation, VFX, audio
3	`03-kith-strays-wild.md`	Strays, wild evolution, Wild Ascendants, the Old Ones
4	`04-bestiary-legs-2-4.md`	Creature stat blocks: four-legged and two-legged natives
5	`05-bestiary-legs-6-8-insects.md`	Creature stat blocks: six-legged, eight-legged and insects
6	`06-variants-invaders-bosses.md`	Regional and Blighted variants, sea creatures, the Clamor, the Hushed Answers
7	`07-structures.md`	Bases, Enemy Cores, Resource Hubs, nodes: dimensions, states, numbers
8	`08-map-rules-ashfall.md`	Map rules and metrics, and Ashfall Crossing in full
9	`09-maps-ribs-canopy.md`	The Elder Ribs and Breathing Canopy in full
10	`10-maps-post-launch.md`	Fevermouth, The Sleeper, Shard Reef, The Nerve and the six later maps
11	`11-world-systems.md`	Weather, time of day, Turns, Tension events, hazards, sound

Status of the content

The document uses three source labels. Where a value matters, it says which one applies.

Label	Meaning
Spec	Taken unchanged from `spec/` (the build-ready numbers). Change the spec first, then this document
Built	What the playable build in `game/` actually does today, including playtest overrides
Proposal	New detail added here for production: dimensions, animation lists, layouts, timings. Open to change in greybox and playtest

When this document and the spec disagree, **the spec wins** and this document gets fixed. When the built game and the spec disagree, the difference is listed in `game/KNOWN_ISSUES.md` (for example the playtest overrides on Base Heart Health and the EXP curve).

Counts at a glance

Content	Count
Playable lineages	7 (six at launch, Stillheart from Season 3)
Ultimate Forms	42
Native creatures	54

Content	Count
Regional variants	8
Blighted forms	53 (every native except the Heartwood Elk)
Sea creatures	4
Clamor creatures	7 (including the Roar)
Hushed Answers (bosses)	6
Old Ones (scenery)	8
Match maps	13 (3 launch, 4 seasonal, 6 later or proposed)

Who uses which part

Discipline	Start with
Level design	Parts 1, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11
Character art	Parts 1, 2, 4, 5, 6 (anatomy, silhouettes, materials, sizes)
Animation	Parts 1, 2, 4, 5, 6 (animation lists, telegraph timings)
VFX	Parts 1, 2, 6, 7, 11
Audio	Every "Audio" row, and Part 11
Gameplay programming	Parts 1, 3, 4, 5, 6 (behaviour state machines and numbers)
Balance	The numbers in every stat block, all labelled Spec

Part 1 — Production Standards

These rules apply to every map, creature and structure in this document. Everything here is a **Proposal** unless it is marked Spec.

1.1 Units and axes

Rule	Value
Length	Metres. 1 engine unit = 1 m
Time	Seconds. Simulation runs at a fixed **30 Hz** (Built)
Angles	Degrees, measured from the creature's facing; "front 120°" means 60° either side of forward
Axes (maps)	**x** runs west → east, **z** runs north → south, **y** is up. The map centre is (0, 0)
Map coordinates in this document	Written `(x, z)` in metres from the centre
Speeds	m/s. **Speed 100% = 5.0 m/s** (Spec)
Damage	Health points. **P** = the attacker's Power (Spec)

1.2 The scale ladder

Everything in the world is built against the Kith. The size jumps between Stages are the core of the game's fantasy, so props must make them obvious.

Reference	Height	Notes
Kith (Base Form)	**1.0 m** (Spec)	Knee-high to a stag. Capsule radius 0.35 m
Stage 1 Ascendant	**2.0 m** (Spec)	Radius 0.7 m
Stage 2 Ascendant	**4.0 m** (Spec)	Radius 1.3 m
Stage 3 Ascendant	**7.5 m** (Spec)	Radius 2.4 m. Taller than most trees
Titan multiplier	×1.3 height (Spec)	A Stage 3 Titan is ~9.8 m
Thornrunner multiplier	×0.8 height, ×1.2 length (Spec)	Low and long
Ashgrass	0.3–0.9 m	Hides a Kith's legs, never its head
Standing Stone	6–12 m	Hides a Stage 2; a Stage 3's head shows above it
Breathing oak	18–25 m	Taller than any Ascendant
Elder Ribs (one rib)	40–60 m	City-block scale
Tier IV Apex	14–30 m	Always taller than a Stage 3
Hushed Answer	12–20 m (Spec)	Larger than a Stage 3

Doorway rule: any gap a player must pass through is at least **5.5 m wide and 10.5 m tall**. A Stage 3 capsule is 4.8 m wide (radius 2.4 m) and a Stage 3 Titan is ~9.8 m tall, so every Ascendant can always get through with a margin. Gaps meant for small creatures only (a Kith shortcut) are **under 1.6 m wide** and signposted with a distinct visual (a root arch, a fallen-log tunnel).

1.3 Creature stat-block format

Every creature in Parts 4–6 uses this block. Fields marked Spec come straight from `spec/04-creatures.md`.

Field	Meaning
Tier	I Critter · II Beast · III Brute · IV Apex (Spec)
Temperament	Passive · Skittish · Territorial · Predator · Scavenger · Swarm · Apex (Spec)
Habitat / maps	Biome, and the maps where it spawns
Affinity	The lineage that gets +25% cores or a stronger effect (Spec)
Group	How many spawn together (Spec)
Size	Height at the shoulder or head, and length (Proposal)
Health · Damage · Interval · Speed	Phase 1 values (Spec). Multiply Health and damage by the phase factor: ×1.00 / 1.15 / 1.30 / 1.45
Aggro · Leash	Radius at which it reacts; how far it follows before resetting (Spec, from the tier baseline unless listed)
Cores · SAP · Respawn	Payout and respawn (Spec)
Weak point	Location, exposure arc and hitbox. ×1.5 damage (Spec rule; location is Proposal)

Field	Meaning
Behaviour	A state machine: states, what triggers each change
Attacks	Each attack with telegraph, wind-up, area, damage, cooldown
Counter-play	What a skilled player does about it
Animation set	The clips the animator must deliver, in priority order
Audio	Idle, alert, attack and death sounds
Look	Silhouette, materials, colours
Blighted form	Name and twist (Spec where listed in `spec/04`)

Tier baselines (Spec)

Tier	Health	Hit damage	Attack interval	Speed (m/s)	Aggro radius	Leash	Cores	SAP	Respawn
I Critter	60–300	0–25	1.5 s	4–10	Flees at 12 m	—	10–20	0	45 s
II Beast	600–1,500	40–70	1.2 s	2.5–8	10 m	25 m	40–70	0	90 s
III Brute	2,200–4,000	110–180	1.5 s	3–5.5	15 m	35 m	120–180	20	180 s
IV Apex	18,000–30,000	250–450	2.0 s	2–6	25 m	None	400 split	100	Once per phase from Phase 3

Shared creature rules (Spec)

Rule	Value
Tenacity	Tier I–II 0% · Tier III 20% · Tier IV immune to all crowd control except slow (max 30%)
Damage reduction cap	75% for Tier I–III. Bosses may exceed it where listed
Leash and reset	Returns to spawn at +50% speed, ignores damage, heals to full
Out of combat	Heals 5% max Health/s after 8 s without combat
Kill credit	Killing blow takes the cores; Tier IV is split by damage share (≥ 3% to qualify)
Assist	Allies who dealt ≥ 10% in the last 15 s get +25% extra cores (paid by the system)
Wildlife income cap	Full value for the first 600 wildlife cores per player per match, then 50%
Tier IV warning	Announced map-wide 10 s before it appears

1.4 Telegraph rules

Every damaging attack in the game must be readable. These minimums apply to all creatures and bosses (Proposal, built on the art direction in `gdd/23`).

Threat	Minimum wind-up	Telegraph
Tier I attack	0.3 s	Body cue only (crouch, wing flare)
Tier II attack	0.4 s	Body cue plus a sound cue
Tier II area attack	0.5 s	Ground decal (thin outline)
Tier III attack	0.5 s	Body cue, sound cue, and a ground decal for any area
Tier III charge or grab	0.6 s	Line or cone decal that fills as the wind-up completes
Tier IV attack	0.8 s	Large decal, a camera-shake pre-rumble within 30 m, and a unique sound
Tier IV "wipe" attack (600+ damage)	2.0–3.0 s	Decal, sound, and a safe zone that is shown, not guessed
Ambush (Hexmaw, Marrow Mantis, Glasslegs)	First strike exempt	A world tell must exist before the strike: ripples in mud, a glint, a too-still shape

Decal colours. Wildlife and boss attack decals use a neutral **pale ochre** (`#D9C08A`) outline that fills toward **warm white**. They never use team colours (gold, red) or side colours (amber, cyan), so "this will hit me" can't be confused with "this belongs to a team".

Ground decal timing. The fill reaches the edge exactly when the hit lands. A decal never appears less than 0.3 s before impact.

1.5 Weak-point rules

Rule	Value
Damage on a weak point	×1.5 (Spec)
Exposed (Marked) weak point	×2.0 for Spire Lance (Spec)

Rule	Value
Hitbox	A sphere sized as a fraction of the creature's height (Spec for Ascendants; Proposal for wildlife: 0.15–0.25 × height)
Look	Glows in the creature's side colour: amber (wild and Wildborn), cyan-violet (Blighted and Blightborn). Neutral creatures use a pale amber
Exposure	Each creature lists the arc from which its weak point can be hit. Outside that arc, hits count as body hits
Readability	A weak point glows brighter for 0.2 s on every hit so attackers learn where it is

1.6 Materials

Three ground materials carry the war (Spec art direction, `gdd/23`):

Material	Owner	Surface	Light	Sound underfoot
Roots	Wildborn	Matte, fibrous, moss	Amber pulses along the roots every 4 s	Soft creak
Blight (Glaze)	Blightborn	Glossy black glass in fine lines	Cyan-violet shimmer moving outward	Faint ring
Scald	The Clamor (Season 3)	Crusted rust-red blotches, steaming	Coal glow in the cracks	Crackle

Greyscale test: with colour removed, roots must read as matte and fibrous, Blight as glossy and linear, Scald as crusted and blotchy.

Palette (Spec art direction)

Role	Hex
Stone	`#6E6A62`
Grass and moss	`#7A8466`
Haze and sky	`#C9C2AE`
Wildborn glow (amber sap)	`#E8A23A`
Moss green	`#5E8C4A`
Blightborn glow (starlit cyan)	`#5FD4E0`
Violet	`#8A5CD6`
Black glass	`#141821`
Scald	`#C2462B`
UI panels	`#0F2A30`
UI headings	`#E2B866`

Team outlines are separate from side colours: your team is pale gold, the enemy is sharp red (colour-blind presets in Part 11).

1.7 Asset budgets (Proposal)

Budgets assume the web build's target: 60 fps at 1080p on a mid-range GPU, with 8 Ascendants, ~40 wildlife and full terrain on screen. Real-GPU measurement is still open (`game/KNOWN_ISSUES.md` #1).

Asset	LOD0 triangles	LOD1	LOD2	Bones	Texture set
Kith / Stage 1 Ascendant	6,000	2,500	800	40	1024² ×3 (albedo, normal, ORM + emissive mask)
Stage 2 Ascendant	10,000	4,000	1,200	55	2048² ×3
Stage 3 Ascendant	16,000	6,000	2,000	70	2048² ×3
Tier I critter	800–1,500	400	billboard / impostor	12–20	512² shared atlas
Tier II beast	3,000	1,200	400	30	1024²
Tier III brute	6,000	2,500	800	45	1024²
Tier IV apex	20,000	8,000	2,500	80	2048² ×2 sets
Hushed Answer	30,000	12,000	4,000	100	2048² ×2 sets
Hub (each Defense stage)	8,000	3,000	800	—	2048² shared with the map
Swarm member (Threadling, wasp, bee)	60–150	GPU instanced	—	4–6 or vertex animation	Atlas

LOD distances: LOD1 at 40 m, LOD2 at 90 m, impostor at 160 m for Tier I–II. Tier IV and Ascendants never drop below LOD2, because silhouettes carry gameplay.

Draw-call rule: grass, flowers, small rocks and swarms are instanced (Built: instanced props and grass with culling).

1.8 Naming

Thing	Pattern	Example
Creature asset	`cr_<tier>_<name>`	`cr_t2_ashfang`
Blighted variant	`cr_<tier>_<name>_bl`	`cr_t2_ashfang_bl` (Shardfang)
Regional variant	`cr_<tier>_<name>_<region>`	`cr_t2_ashfang_rime` (Frostfang)
Ascendant	`asc_<lineage>_s<stage>_<side>`	`asc_titan_s2_wb`, `asc_titan_s2_bb`
Map	`map_<id>_<name>`	`map_01_ashfall`
Node (in a map)	`<side letter><number>` or a callout name	`W7`, `The Ash Knoll`
Animation clip	`<asset>@<clip>`	`cr_t3_stonehide_ox@charge_windup`
Sound event	`sfx/<category>/<asset>/<event>`	`sfx/cr/ashfang/bite`

1.9 Behaviour state machine conventions

Every creature's behaviour in Parts 4–6 is written as states. The shared states are defined once here:

State	Meaning
Idle	At or near its spawn, playing its idle loop. Wanders up to 6 m (Tier I–II) or 10 m (Tier III)
Alert	Has noticed something within its aggro radius. Turns to face it for 0.5–1.0 s before choosing
Flee	Runs away from the threat for 3–6 s, then returns to Idle when it's more than 20 m away
Engage	Attacking a target. Chooses attacks by range and cooldown
Leash	Pulled past its leash: returns to spawn at +50% speed, ignores damage, heals to full
Recover	8 s without combat: heals 5% max Health/s, then Idle
Dead	Death animation, drops its cores, starts its respawn timer
Converted	Infected (Blightborn) or rallied (Wildborn) for 90 s. Follows its converter within 25 m (Spec)

Target choice (default): the player that damaged it most in the last 5 s; if none, the nearest player. Exceptions are listed per creature (Ashfang hunts the weakest, Siege Beetle chases its last attacker, Clamor creatures go for the loudest).

Perception (from `gdd/43`): each Ascendant has three values that wildlife reads.

Lineage	Threat	Presence (noticed from)	Attraction
Titan	Medium	High (Stage × 12 m)	Small critters hide; Cairnshells climb on it
Brawler	High	Medium	Herds scatter early
Verdant	Low	Medium	Grazers and Sapback Aphids follow it
Hollow	Medium	Low (×0.5)	Birds stop singing
Thornrunner	High	Low (×0.5)	Prey flees before it is visible
Bonespire	Medium	Medium	Scavengers follow it
Stillheart	Low	Medium	Hoarfrost Mites swarm to it

Reaction rule: wildlife reactions are hints, never more revealing than the player's own sound signature. A reaction can never show a hidden player's exact position on the minimap.

Part 2 — The Ascendants

The seven playable lineages, from the Kith Base Form to Stage 3. Numbers are **Spec** (`spec/02`, `spec/03`, `gdd/02`) unless marked otherwise. Anatomy, dimensions, animation lists and effect breakdowns are **Proposal**.

2.0 Shared rules

Stages

Stage	Levels	Height	Capsule radius	Camera distance	Turn rate	Ability scaling
Base Form	1–2	1.0 m	0.35 m	5 m	540°/s	—
Stage 1	3–9	2.0 m	0.7 m	7 m	450°/s	×1.0
Stage 2	10–19	4.0 m	1.3 m	10 m	360°/s	×1.25
Stage 3	20	7.5 m	2.4 m	15 m	270°/s	×1.6

(Turn rates for Stage 1 and 2 are Proposal, interpolated from the Spec endpoints.)

Milestones

Level	What happens
3	Lineage awakens (Q, E, R, passive)
5	Rank 2: the lineage's first upgrade
8	Cross-resonance with non-pair allies
10	Stage 2; branch choice (Aggression or Tactical Control)
12 / 15 / 18	Void Garden / Co-Stalk / Smash & Roll unlock
15	Second branch upgrade; Tenacity stops growing
16+	Territorial Dominance share per level
20	Stage 3; choose one of three Ultimate Forms

Branch stats: Aggression +10% Power, +5% Speed, kills drop +15% cores. Tactical Control +15% Control, +10% Health, captures +25% faster.

Transformation sequence (all lineages)

Time	Wildborn	Blightborn	Audio
0.0 s	Rooted in place, invulnerable	Same	Local sound ducks −12 dB for 0.2 s
0.2 s	Roots burst from the ground and wrap the body	A crystal cocoon forms instantly	Roots tearing / crystal growing in a ring
0.8 s	—	—	**Map-wide cue:** a deep tremor (Wildborn) or a ringing chime with whispers (Blightborn)
1.2 s	The roots fall away	The cocoon shatters outward	Debris
1.5 s	New form stands and calls; camera eases out	Same	Lineage call, now one Stage deeper

Ember Moths (Ashfall Crossing) are drawn to any transformation within 30 m.

Animation set every lineage needs

Listed once here; each lineage adds its own signature clips.

Priority	Clips
1 Gameplay	Basic attack (each hit of the combo), Q / E / R (wind-up, active, recovery), Evade, hit-react light and heavy, stagger, stun loop, Airborne, knockback land, Root channel loop, Convert kneel loop, death
2 Readability	Weak-point exposure pose (where the kit exposes it), hurt walk (below 35% Health), size-fear crouch (Stage 1 near an enemy two Stages larger)
3 Identity	Walk, run, sprint, turn-in-place, idle, carry-heavy walk (300+ cores: heavier steps, glow on the back)
4 World	Feeding (core pickup), resting, pair greeting, brood turn, respawn budding
5 Seasonal	Turn idles (shiver in Rime, pant in Fever)

Every clip is delivered once per Stage (four rigs: Base Form, S1, S2, S3) and shared between the Wildborn and Blightborn versions (identical silhouettes and timings).

2.1 The Kith Base Form (Levels 1–2)

Field	Value
Role	Every player at the start of a match
Height	1.0 m at the shoulder; head adds 0.25 m
Proportions	Large head (25% of height), big amber eyes, long mobile ears, slender limbs, short expressive tail
Hands	Four long fingers with blunt claws
Skin	Grey, moss-flecked; soft bark plates on the shoulders and spine (where lineage growth begins at L3)
Stats (Spec)	Health 600 · Power 40 · Speed 100% · Control 10
Basic attack (Spec)	Scratch combo, 2 m, 1.2 hits/s, third hit 0.4 s slower, 1.0 × P per hit; third hit staggers critters
Evade (Spec)	4 m dash, 0.25 s, invulnerable 0.15 s, cooldown 8 s
Root (Spec)	4 s channel within 2 m of a node core
Weak point	None (Base Forms die fast enough)
Hushed Kith (Blightborn)	Same body; glass patches along the spine, faint cyan veins, violet flickering eyes, a tail that rarely moves

Signature behaviour. Curious, twitchy and playful: ears turn toward sounds, it sniffs the air, it startles at loud noises. At Base Form the call wheel uses wild Kith sounds: a chirp ("I'm here"), rapid clicks ("danger"), a low hum ("all is well"), a rising whistle ("food here") and the distress call.

First signs of a lineage at L3 (the bark plates change first): Titan, shoulder plates thicken into stone · Brawler, arms lengthen and knuckles harden · Verdant, antler buds · Hollow, a dark opening in the chest · Thornrunner, thorns along the spine and extra legs forming · Bonespire, bone spikes along the back · Stillheart, frost on the fur. The Kith's eyes stay the same through Stage 1 and change only at Stage 2.

Silhouette test: a Base Form must read as different from every Stage 1 lineage at 40 m. The giveaway is the big head and the lack of any growth on the back.

2.2 Titan — the mountain that fights (Commit pair)

Role: juggernaut and front line. Slowest and hardest to kill; the best crowd-control setup in the game.

Numbers (Spec)

Stat	L1	L3	L5	L10	L15	L20
Health	600	1,000	1,500	2,600	3,900	5,200
Power	40	55	70	100	140	180
Speed	100%	97%	95%	90%	87%	85%
Control	10	18	25	40	58	70

Size: ×1.3 height. Stage 1 2.6 m · Stage 2 5.2 m · Stage 3 9.75 m.

Kit (Spec)

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
Basic	Fist slam	Melee 3 m (scales)	0.8 hits/s	—	1.2 × P	—
Passive	Immovable	—	—	Immune to knockback and Grapple; −10% damage from lower-Stage enemies	—	—
Q	Quake Slam	Circle r 5 m (scales)	0.5 s wind-up, visible ring	Stagger 0.8 s; Smash & Roll trigger	60 + 0.8 × P	12 s
E	Bulwark	Front 120° cone	Instant, 3 s	−60% damage from the front; Titan slowed 30%	—	16 s
R	Rampart Charge	Line 12 m (scales)	0.3 s wind-up, 1.0 s charge	Unstoppable; carries up to 2 enemies	80 + 1.0 × P	18 s
Rank 2	L5	—	—	Quake Slam radius +20%	—	—
Rule	Commitment (from L18)	—	—	If no Brawler ally starts Roll Commit within 1.5 s of a Quake Slam, its cooldown is +50%	—	—

Weak point: crystal spine on the back. Sphere radius 0.25 × height. Exposed from the rear 120°.

Branches: Aggression: L10 stagger 1.0 s; L15 Rampart Charge ends in a second slam (r 4 m, 50%). Tactical: L10 Bulwark also gives −30% damage to allies within 4 m behind; L15 Bulwark lasts 4 s.

Ultimates: Colossus Step · Avalanche · Shatterfist (Aggression) — Fortress · Fault Line · Mountain's Patience (Tactical). Numbers in `spec/03`.

Anatomy by Stage

Stage	Wildborn	Blightborn	Key proportions
S1 (2.6 m)	A hunched Kith with stone plates fused across the shoulders and back; amber eyes under a brow of rock	Plates of black glass with cyan cracks; violet eyes	Shoulders 1.6× hip width; arms reach the knees
S2 (5.2 m)	Heavy, knuckle-walking colossus; moss carpet on the back; the amber crystal ridge of the weak point runs down the spine	Smooth glass planes with veins of light running upward	Head sits below the shoulder line; knuckles carry 40% of the weight
S3 (9.75 m)	A walking mountain: small trees on the shoulders, roots trailing from the feet, a root-print left at each step	A glass mountain like the Glass Range; the ground rings like a bell	Back ridge rises 1.5 m above the head; legs are short pillars

Signature animation

Clip	Notes
Quake Slam	0.5 s raise of both fists (the ring decal appears at 0.0 s and fills to the edge at 0.5 s), impact frame with a 0.15 s hold
Bulwark	Forearms crossed in front; stone (or glass) plates slide over the forearms; a 30% slower guard walk
Rampart Charge	0.3 s lowered-shoulder crouch, then a lumbering sprint; carried enemies pinned against the shoulder
Settle (rest)	Lowers to the ground and becomes nearly indistinguishable from rock
Feeding	Scoops cores in a cupped hand; the glow travels down a stone throat

Effects and audio

Event	Wildborn	Blightborn
Footstep	Grinding rock; small debris shakes loose; heard through walls from Stage 2	A struck-glass-bowl tone
Quake Slam	Dust ring, rock chips, a low thud felt in the controller	Glass shards spray in a ring; a bell strike
Bulwark	Stone plates grinding into place	Glass plates chiming into place
Transformation flourish	Boulders rise and fuse onto the body	Black glass erupts and sets like cooling lava

Counter-play: flank to the back (crystal spine), bait the Quake Slam before committing, kite it (lowest speed in the game), punish a lone slam (Commitment rule). Strong against Brawler dives and Verdant channels; weak against Bonespire at range and Hollow drain.

2.3 Brawler — the storm that commits (Commit pair)

Role: diver and bruiser. Burst damage, unstoppable engage, the best carrier-hunter.

Numbers (Spec endpoints)

Stat	L1	L10	L20
Health	600	2,000	3,800
Power	40	130	240
Speed	100%	105%	110%
Control	10	30	50

Growth between endpoints follows the S-curve (fastest between L8 and L16). **Size:** standard. S1 2.0 m · S2 4.0 m · S3 7.5 m.

Kit (Spec)

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
Basic	Fist combo	Melee 2.5 m (scales)	1.4 hits/s	—	1.0 × P	—
Passive	Momentum	—	+5 per hit, +2/s moving in combat, decays 10/s	At 100: +15% attack speed	—	—
Q	Roll	Line 8 m	0.6 s roll	Unstoppable; uppercut staggers 0.5	70 + 1.0 × P	10 s

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
	Commit	(scales)		s; **chest weak point exposed 1.0 s after**		
E	Haymaker	Melee 3 m	Charge 0.3–1.5 s	Full charge knocks back 6 m	50 + 0.6 × P to 120 + 1.4 × P	9 s
R	Grapple	Melee 3 m	0.6 s hold, then throw	Lower-Stage target thrown 8 m	40 + 0.5 × P, +40 on landing	16 s
Rank 2	L5	—	—	Haymaker full charge in 1.3 s	—	—

Weak point: chest plate. Sphere radius 0.2 × height. Only hittable from the front, and only for 1.0 s after Roll Commit ends.

Branches: Aggression: L10 Haymaker charges 30% faster; L15 Roll Commit refunds 30% on a takedown. Tactical: L10 Grapple onto a node interrupts its capture and staggers 0.5 s; L15 Grapple works on same-Stage targets.

Ultimates: Frenzy · Wrecking Rush · Last Stand — Pin · Brawl Circle · Shove of the Storm.

Anatomy by Stage

Stage	Wildborn	Blightborn	Key proportions
S1 (2.0 m)	Wiry, long-armed Kith with hardened knuckles and a bark-plated chest	Geode knuckles, glass plates	Arm span 1.8× height
S2 (4.0 m)	Gorilla-like beast; thick fur at the joints, bark armour, heartwood chest plate	Crystal studs on the fists, shard spikes along the back, a geode chest	Forearms twice the thickness of the upper arms
S3 (7.5 m)	Armoured berserker; bark cracks and regrows with every punch	Glass dust bursts from every blow	Fists the size of its head

Signature animation

Clip	Notes
Roll Commit	Tucks into an armoured ball, rolls 8 m, unfurls into an uppercut; the chest plate swings open during the 1.0 s recovery (a clear pose, held)
Haymaker	Arm drawn back; the charge level shows as the arm coiling further and the fist glowing brighter in three steps
Grapple	Two-hand grab, lift overhead, throw; the thrown target tumbles
Idle	Never still: paces, cracks its knuckles, beats its chest
Feeding	Snatches and tears into cores greedily

Effects and audio

Event	Wildborn	Blightborn
Momentum	A rising snarl; fur bristles at 100	The snarl doubled by a whisper a fraction behind
Haymaker hit	Splinters and a bark crack	Shards and a geode crack
Transformation	Bark splits and regrows thicker across the fists	Geodes crack open along the arms

Counter-play: sidestep the roll (it's a straight line), punish the 1.0 s chest exposure, stay out of Grapple range at a lower Stage, peel with slows. Strong against Bonespire and Thornrunner; weak against a Titan's guard and Stillheart's Lull.

2.4 Verdant — the forest that claims (Root & Void pair)

Role: territory controller and sustain. Fastest capture, healing, path control.

Numbers (Spec endpoints)

Stat	L1	L10	L20
Health	600	1,800	3,400
Power	40	85	150
Speed	100%	95%	95%
Control	10	60	110

Size: standard, but tall and slender: antlers add 30% to the visual height.

Kit (Spec)

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage / heal	Cooldown
Basic	Antler sweep	Melee 3 m (scales)	1.0 hits/s	—	0.9 × P	—
Passive	Deep Root	—	—	Root channel 2 s; its nodes spread to one adjacent neutral cell every 20 s	—	—
Q	Bramble Wall	Wall 10 m (scales), 1.5 m tall, up to 15 m away	0.4 s to grow, lasts 6 s	Blocks movement and projectiles	Wall Health 400 + 2 × P	18 s
E	Sap Draw	Ally or self within 15 m	Heal over 4 s	Costs 40 team SAP	120 + 1.0 × P	10 s
R	Entangle	Circle r 3 m (scales), up to 15 m away	0.6 s delay	Root 1.2 s	30 + 0.4 × P	14 s
Rank 2	L5	—	—	Entangle root 1.5 s	—	—

Weak point: bloom pod on the shoulder. Radius 0.2 × height. Exposed from the left and right 90° arcs; +50% size while channelling Root.

Branches: Aggression: L10 Entangle deals damage over time; L15 Bramble Wall damages on touch. Tactical: L10 allies on a node it is rooting heal 2%/s; L15 Bramble Wall lasts 8 s.

Ultimates: Thornstorm · Strangling Grove · Sap Frenzy — Overgrowth · Living Wall · Greenhome.

Anatomy by Stage

Stage	Wildborn	Blightborn
S1	Slender Kith with antler buds; moss spreading down its legs	Glass buds; frost-like Glaze on its legs
S2	A stag of living wood; flowering antlers; amber bloom pod on the shoulder	Glass antlers; crystal flowers that never open; a crystal bud
S3	A walking grove: birds and insects live in its branches	A slow garden of glass, the Lattice Grove's child

Signature animation and effects

Clip / event	Notes
Movement	Graceful, unhurried, like a deer through a forest; leaves moss footprints (Wildborn) or Glaze prints (Blightborn) that fade over 6 s
Root channel	Forelegs planted, head lowered; roots (or Glaze lines) spread from the hooves; the bloom pod swells (the +50% weak-point growth must be visible)
Bramble Wall	Grows in a 0.4 s wave from the near end to the far end
Sap Draw	An amber (cyan) stream arcs to the target
Idle	Grazes; antler flowers open and close
Audio	Creaking wood and rustling, heard by anyone on its territory (Blightborn: wind chimes and tinkling glass)
Transformation	A burst of leaves and petals / glass petals that ring as they fall

Counter-play: interrupt its channels (damage breaks Root), hit the bloom pod from the side while it roots, burn its SAP by forcing Sap Draws. Weak against Thornrunner flanks and Brawler dives.

2.5 Hollow — the silence that controls (Root & Void pair)

Role: void caster and zone denial. Decides where fights happen.

Numbers (Spec endpoints)

Stat	L1	L10	L20
Health	600	1,600	3,000
Power	40	115	210
Speed	100%	100%	100%
Control	10	55	100

Size: standard height but it floats 0.3–0.6 m above the ground (Proposal; the capsule stays on the ground for collision).

Kit (Spec)

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
Basic	Void bolt	Ranged 15 m, 30 m/s	1.0 shots/s	—	0.8 × P	—

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
Passive	Hush	—	—	No footstep sounds; ambient sound dims nearby	—	—
Q	Void Rift	Circle r 4 m (scales), up to 18 m away	0.3 s to open, 4 s	Slow 30%, Control −40%; Void Garden trigger	—	14 s
E	Hollow Step	Blink 8 m (scales)	0.1 s	Passes through units and Bramble Walls, not terrain	—	12 s
R	Null Pulse	Circle r 6 m (scales) around self	0.3 s wind-up	Silence 1.5 s	40 + 0.5 × P	20 s
Rank 2	L5	—	—	Void Rift slow 40%	—	—

Weak point: core cavity in the torso. Radius 0.35 × height (the largest). Exposed from the front 120°; +30% size during the Null Pulse wind-up.

Branches: Aggression: L10 Void Rift damages; L15 Hollow Step leaves an exploding echo. Tactical: L10 Void Rift +30% radius; L15 Null Pulse cancels channels.

Ultimates: Collapse · Hollow Out · Unmaking — Event Horizon · Silence of the Deep · Step Between.

Anatomy by Stage

Stage	Wildborn	Blightborn
S1	Thin Kith with a small dark opening in the chest	The opening holds tiny turning shards
S2	Shadowy floating wraith, robed in hanging bark-strips; chest cavity of soft darkness and floating seeds	Cavity full of slowly turning shards
S3	A cave turned inside out, floating; roots hang like a curtain	Half-invisible, outlined in faint violet light (the Unspoken's heir)

Silhouette rule: a visible hole through the torso at every Stage. Light from behind must pass through it.

Signature animation and effects

Clip / event	Notes
Movement	Glides; no footsteps; robe-strips trail
Hollow Step	Folds inward to a point (0.05 s) and unfolds at the destination; a faint afterimage for 0.3 s
Null Pulse	Chest cavity widens over 0.3 s (the weak point grows +30%), then a ring of silence: all sound in the radius drops for 1.5 s, replaced by a muffled heartbeat
Void Rift	A disc of darkness with seeds (shards) drifting upward
Audio	An inverted hum; nearby sound briefly drops out (Blightborn: a chorus of faint whispers below hearing)
Wildlife	Birds stop singing; creatures fall still
Transformation	Darkness folds inward, then opens / shards spiral into the chest cavity

Counter-play: it's fragile with a huge frontal weak point; Mark Prey reveals it; dive it after Hollow Step is spent. Weak against Thornrunner and Brawler.

2.6 Thornrunner — the hunt that finds (Hunt pair)

Role: stalker, scout and assassin. Fastest and quietest; marks prey for the team.

Numbers (Spec endpoints)

Stat	L1	L10	L20
Health	600	1,500	2,800
Power	40	125	230
Speed	100%	120%	135%
Control	10	35	60

Size: ×0.8 height, ×1.2 length. S1 1.6 m tall, 2.4 m long · S2 3.2 m, 4.8 m · S3 6.0 m, 9.0 m.

Kit (Spec)

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
Basic	Claw rake	Melee 2.5 m (scales)	1.6 hits/s	—	0.8 × P	—
Passive	Hunter's Silence	—	—	Footsteps heard at ×0.5 range; +15% speed out of combat	—	—

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
Q	Thorn Dash	Line 9 m (scales), passes through	0.3 s	Bleed on everyone passed	40 + 0.6 × P, bleed 10 + 0.15 × P per s for 4 s	8 s
E	Mark Prey	Target within 25 m, line of sight	Instant	Reveals 6 s; weak point exposed from every angle to the team; Co-Stalk trigger	—	16 s
R	Barb Volley	Cone 60°, 8 m	0.2 s	8 barbs, up to 5 on a close target	12 + 0.15 × P per barb	10 s
Rank 2	L5	—	—	Bleed lasts 5 s	—	—

Weak point: abdomen sac. Radius 0.2 × height. Exposed from the left and right 90° arcs, and for 0.5 s after Thorn Dash ends.

Branches: Aggression: L10 bleed 6 s; L15 second Thorn Dash charge. Tactical: L10 Mark lasts 8 s; L15 Mark slows 20%.

Ultimates: Hunt Frenzy · Gut the Hoard · Endless Pursuit — Pack Hunt · Thicket Trap · Scent Trail.

Anatomy by Stage

Stage	Wildborn	Blightborn
S1	Low, spiny Kith with extra legs beginning to form along its sides	Glass needles instead of thorns
S2	Long-legged insectile quadruped (six legs, front pair raptorial) with an amber abdomen sac	Glass needles, pulsing cyan sac
S3	Bladed horror with hooked legs and thorn-tails; still part animal	Trails glittering dust like the Endless Pursuit

Signature animation and effects

Clip / event	Notes
Freeze-strike	Total stillness for 0.2–3 s when it senses an enemy, then an explosive start. The freeze is the tell
Thorn Dash	Low lunge; the abdomen sac swings out to the side during the 0.5 s recovery (weak point exposed)
Mark Prey	Head snaps toward the target; a thin thorn-thread (glass thread) links them for 0.3 s; the target's weak point lights up for the whole team
Idle	Head twitches in quick jerks; tastes the air; grooms its thorns
Audio	Skittering and thorn clicks, the quietest Ascendant at every Stage (Blightborn: glass skittering like ice cracking)
Wildlife	Prey flees before it's visible
Transformation	Thorns lengthen with a creak / needles shoot out with a chiming snap

Counter-play: stay grouped (it hunts lone carriers), use area control, punish its low Health once it's revealed. Weak against a Titan in close range.

2.7 Bonespire — the memory that strikes from afar (Hunt pair)

Role: siege sniper. Long range, weak-point breaker, structure killer.

Numbers (Spec endpoints)

Stat	L1	L10	L20
Health	600	1,450	2,700
Power	40	140	260
Speed	100%	92%	90%
Control	10	45	80

Size: standard; spines add up to 40% visual height at Stage 3.

Kit (Spec)

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
Basic	Bone shard	Ranged 25 m, 40 m/s	0.9 shots/s	—	1.1 × P	—
Passive	Rememberer	—	—	+1 bone per takedown (max 10), each +1% Power; bones shown on its back	—	—
Q	Spire Lance	Skillshot 40 m (S2 45, S3 50), width 0.6 m	0.6 s wind-up, loud crack heard at 60 m; 60 m/s	×1.5 weak point; ×2.0 exposed; Co-Stalk trigger	90 + 1.2 × P	9 s

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
E	Ossuary	Fence 8 m (scales), up to 15 m away	0.3 s to rise, 5 s	Blocks movement, not projectiles	Fence Health 300 + 1.5 × P	16 s
R	Calcify	Projectile 20 m	0.2 s	Slow 25% → 50% → stun 1.0 s on the third hit within 3 s	25 + 0.3 × P	6 s
Rank 2	L5	—	—	Spire Lance 72 m/s	—	—

Weak point: marrow spire on the back. Radius 0.22 × height. Exposed from the rear 120°; +30% size during the Spire Lance wind-up.

Branches: Aggression: L10 Lance pierces (60% to the second); L15 second Lance charge. Tactical: L10 Ossuary lasts 7 s; L15 Calcify stun 1.5 s.

Ultimates: Marrow Barrage · Siege Spire · Rememberer's Aim — Bone Cathedral · Ossuary Maze · Fossilise.

Anatomy by Stage

Stage	Wildborn	Blightborn
S1	Hunched Kith with small bone spikes rising from its back	Glass spikes
S2	Ballista-beast: fossil spines, a pale marrow spire, a long bracing tail	Black glass spines, glowing cyan spire
S3	A walking reliquary of bones from every creature it has hunted	Glass copies of its victims' bones, like the Archive

Signature animation and effects

Clip / event	Notes
Spire Lance	Plants its forelegs, tail braces, the spire on its back tilts forward and glows (0.6 s); the crack at release is the loudest player sound in the game
Rememberer bones	Up to 10 extra bone pieces snap onto the back, one per takedown, kept until death
Movement	Hunched and deliberate, like a heron stalking
Rest	One leg raised, like a sleeping heron
Audio	Bone clicking; a hollow crack when it fires (Blightborn: glass ringing, a shatter when it fires)
Wildlife	Scavengers (Marrowhounds, Ash Vultures) follow it
Transformation	Bones rattle up from the ground and lock onto the back / glass bones grow out of the spine

Counter-play: follow the crack to find it, dive it (slow, fragile), hit the spire from behind. Strong against Titans and structures.

2.8 Stillheart — the patience that stops fire (from Season 3)

Role: tempo controller and support. No pair of its own; a universal partner.

Numbers (Spec endpoints)

Stat	L1	L10	L20
Health	600	2,200	4,200
Power	40	85	150
Speed	100%	90%	90%
Control	10	55	100

Size: standard height; long-limbed, shaggy and rounded.

Kit (Spec)

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
Basic	Frost swipe	Melee 3 m (scales)	0.9 hits/s	Slows 10% for 1 s	0.9 × P	—
Passive	Slow Heart	—	—	Out-of-combat regeneration 3%/s; footsteps ×0.7 range	—	—
Partner	Lullaby Resonance	15 m	—	Allies' Synergy cooldowns −10%	—	—
Partner	Attunement	Ally within 5 m	2 s channel, once per life	Bonus by the ally's lineage (`spec/02`)	—	—
Q	Lull	Cone 50°, 10 m (scales)	0.3 s	Slow 40% for 2 s; second Lull in 3 s: Drowse 1.0 s	20 + 0.3 × P	7 s

Slot	Ability	Area	Timing	Effect	Damage	Cooldown
E	Hibernate	Self or ally within 12 m	Instant, 2 s	Ice stasis: invulnerable, can't act; carried cores safe	—	24 s
R	Long Night	Circle r 7 m (scales), up to 15 m away	0.5 s to form, 5 s	Enemy cooldowns tick 30% slower inside	—	22 s
Rank 2	L5	—	—	Lull slow 45%	—	—

Weak point: the heart. Radius 0.3 × height. Exposed from the front 180°, always visible (glowing).

Ultimates: Killing Frost · Rime March · Avalanche Heart — The Deep Sleep · Winter's Wall · Long Dream.

Anatomy by Stage

Stage	Wildborn	Blightborn
S1	Curled, frost-furred Kith, sleepy-eyed	Frost replaced by fine glass needles
S2	Long-limbed, ice-antlered, sloth-like; a visible heart behind a window of clear ice	Black glass antlers; a cyan heart
S3	A walking glacier with a slow-beating heart in its icy chest	A glacier of dark crystal, its heart pulsing cyan-violet

Signature animation and effects

Clip / event	Notes
Heartbeat	Visible and audible: ~40 bpm calm, ~140 bpm in a fight (drives an emissive pulse on the heart)
Movement	Very slow, then suddenly fast
Rest	Falls asleep standing up; frost creeps over it
Hibernate	A block of ice forms around the target in 0.15 s; carried cores visible frozen inside
Long Night	A dome of dusk with slow-falling snow; enemy ability icons inside visibly tick slower
Audio	A slow, deep heartbeat; frost crackling
Transformation	Frost spreads and thickens into ice / frost turns to black glass

Counter-play: poke it from range (its heart is always visible), fight it in long fights where its cooldowns are spent. Strong against Brawlers and other divers.

2.9 Silhouettes at match distance

Every lineage must be recognisable in solid black at 60 m:

Lineage	Silhouette key
Kith	Big head, big ears, no growths
Titan	Huge, broad, top-heavy; a ridge along the back
Brawler	Hunched; long arms; knuckle-walking
Verdant	Tall, slender legs; wide branching antlers
Hollow	Thin, floating; a hole through the torso
Thornrunner	Low and long; many legs; spiked outline
Bonespire	Hunched; tall spikes rising from the back
Stillheart	Long-limbed and antlered; rounded, shaggy outline

2.10 Death and respawn

Moment	Wildborn	Blightborn
Killed	Sinks to its knees, lies down; moss creeps over it before it fades (2.5 s)	Freezes, glazes over, shatters into glittering dust (1.5 s)
Base Form killed	A soft fall; a seed of light drifts toward the Cradle	A crystal crack; a spark drifts toward the Clutch
Ascendant killed	A heavy collapse that shakes the ground within 30 m; flowers open where it lay	A ringing shatter heard across the map; shards scatter
Dropped cores	Glow on the ground for 30 s (Spec); anyone can pick them up	Same
Respawn time (Spec)	5 s + 1 s × level; +5 s in Phase 4	Same
Respawn visual	Budding from a fresh root knot at the Cradle	A crystal pod cracking open at the Clutch

Part 3 — Strays, Wild Evolution and the Old Ones

The Kith are the players' own species, living wild. This part covers Strays as wildlife, the wild evolution chain that can end in a Wild Ascendant, and the Old Ones that stand on the horizon. Numbers are **Spec** (`spec/04`); the rest is **Proposal**.

3.1 Strays (#9) — stat block

Field	Value
Tier / temperament	I · Skittish, group of 3 (Spec)
Habitat / maps	Every map. 2–3 groups per map, in mirrored positions near each team's territory edge
Affinity	All lineages
Size	1.0 m at the shoulder (a Kith)
Health · damage · speed	200 · 15 per hit · 5.5 m/s (Spec)
Cores	15 each (Spec)
Respawn	45 s
Weak point	None
Elder	1 group in 3 includes an **elder** (grey muzzle, thick cracked plates, 260 Health). Killing the elder makes the others flee for 6 s. While the elder lives, the wild-evolution timer runs 25% slower

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Forage	Default	Wanders within 10 m of its spawn, sniffing, nibbling Sapbloom, chasing critters
Alert	A player within 12 m	All three ears turn; one gives the rapid-click danger call
Flee	A player within 8 m, or any damage	Runs as a group to the far side of its spawn area; regroups after 4 s
Fight back	Cornered (can't flee further than 3 m)	Scratch combo, 15 damage, 1.5 s interval
Watch	A birth-pool within 25 m	Stops and watches the pool, curious (cosmetic)
Dusk	Time of day reaches dusk	All turn north toward the Fall-line and stand still for 6 s (cosmetic)
Grieve	A group member dies	The others stay near the body for 3 s unless a player is within 8 m
Stir	300 s unharmed within 30 m of any held territory (Spec)	Begins wild evolution (below)

Animation set: forage, sniff, chase-play, alert ears, danger call, flee run, scratch, grieve (head lowered), dusk stillness, death (soft fall, sinks into moss).

Audio: chirps, clicks, a low hum when resting, the distress call (also the Base Form's distress call, so players learn it in the first minute).

Blighted form — Hushed Strays: glass patches, violet eyes, still tails. They rest in rows, not rings, and never face north at dusk. **They stir after 180 s instead of 300 s** (Spec).

3.2 Wild evolution (Spec numbers)

Step	Trigger	Stats	Reward
Stray	—	Tier I (above)	15 cores
Stirring Stray (visual only)	The 300 s timer passes its halfway point	As a Stray; limbs lengthen, a bark ridge grows along the spine	—
Wild Brute	A Stray unharmed for 300 s within 30 m of held territory	Tier III: 2,800 Health, 150 damage, 5.0 m/s, leash 30 m	160 cores + 20 SAP
Wild Ascendant	A Wild Brute alive for 300 more seconds; **max once per match**	Stage 3 size; 12,000 Health; Q/E/R of a random lineage at Rank 3, Power = 60% of that lineage's L20 Power; no Ultimate; leash 40 m	400 cores (split) + a **Wild Echo** for the killing team, 60 s

Wild Brute — stat block (Proposal detail on Spec numbers)

Field	Value
Size	3.0 m; a Kith grown thick and hunched, bark plates fused into crude armour
Behaviour	Territorial around the node nearest its birthplace; attacks anyone within 15 m; returns at 30 m
Attacks	Slam (150 damage, melee 3 m, 0.6 s wind-up, 1.5 s interval) · Lunge (6 m line, 0.7 s wind-up, 120 damage, knockback 3 m, 8 s cooldown)

Field	Value
Weak point	A cracked plate between the shoulder blades, rear 120°
Telegraph	Both arms raised for the Slam; a low crouch and ground decal for the Lunge
Counter-play	Kill it before the next 300 s pass, or the Wild Ascendant appears
Audio	Deep chirps turned into a growl; the Kith distress call, distorted, when hurt

Wild Ascendant — boss-lite encounter

Field	Value
Size	Stage 3 (7.5 m; ×1.3 for a Titan)
Look	The planet's raw idea of the lineage: asymmetric, unpolished, **no team outline, no side colour, no Blight**
Announcement	Map-wide: the ground near it shakes; a low horn (neutral, neither side's sound) 5 s before it stands
Behaviour	Defends the nodes within 25 m of where it grew; attacks both teams; does not hunt across the map
Health	12,000, phase-scaled
Target	The nearest player inside its territory; switches to whoever deals the most damage over 3 s
Kill target	~20–30 s with a full brood (Spec tuning target)

Lineage	Wild form	Wild behaviour	Wild Echo (60 s, whole team)
Titan	Jagged unworked rock, no moss, one shoulder higher	Stands on its node and refuses to move; slams anything close	−10% damage taken
Brawler	Shaggy, scarred, mismatched fists (one far larger)	Charges anything that moves, then returns panting	+10% move speed
Verdant	Bare branches for antlers; bark peeling in strips	Roots the ground constantly, growing a ring of thorny undergrowth (slows 20%)	Captures +25% faster
Hollow	A ragged empty hole in the chest; trails darkness like smoke	Drifts in circles; opens rifts at random every 8–12 s	Sound signatures halved
Thornrunner	Too many legs; thorns pointing every direction	Circles its territory at full speed	Enemies carrying 200+ cores revealed
Bonespire	Spines of bones from everything it has eaten, at odd angles	Lances anything entering its line of sight, from far away	+20% weak-point damage
Stillheart	Thick dirty frost; heart barely beating	Sleeps until disturbed, then freezes everything nearby	Cooldowns 10% faster

Tuning targets (Spec): appears in 10–20% of matches; about 60% are killed by the team whose territory it grew beside; the Wild Echo should swing a fight, not a match.

3.3 The Old Ones (scenery)

The Old Ones are **invulnerable scenery** (Spec). They appear on map horizons and, rarely, during an **Old One Crossing** event: for 60 s one walks a path across the map, and within 25 m roots and Blight both spread ×2 (capture and uproot −30%) for both teams (Spec).

Old One	Lineage	Height (Proposal)	Seen from	Look	Sound
Greymother	Verdant	35 m (antlers a living canopy)	Southern horizons; Heartwood groves	Antlers grown into a living tree; Mossbacks graze in her shadow	Deep creaking; birdsong in her antlers
The Cairnback	Titan	60 m (mostly rock)	Fevermouth, Elder Ribs (west skyline)	A moving mountain; Cairnshells on its back, Sky Pines on its shoulders	Very slow grinding stone; pebbles falling
Old Hush	Hollow	25 m, floating	Breathing Canopy (above the mire)	Floats so still birds land on it	Nothing; the swamp fades quiet as you approach
The Scarred Runner	Thornrunner	9 m tall, 14 m long	Ashfall Crossing (beside the Migration)	One-eyed, grey-muzzled; walks, never runs	A slow clicking walk; soft panting
The Last Bellow	Brawler	20 m sitting	Shard Reef (a distant cliff)	Fists worn smooth from pounding cliffs	One great roar each Fever
The Bone-Keeper	Bonespire	15 m	The Elder Ribs (far out on the flats)	Tends fields of arranged bones	Bones clicking into place, one at a time
The Drowsing One	Stillheart	18 m	The Sleeper, Frozen Falls (deep in an ice cave)	An older, smaller Stillheart; Drift Owlbears sleep around it	A heartbeat slower than the Sleeper's
The Rootless	Verdant	22 m	The Glass Forest (walking the edge)	Antlers with a few glass leaves among real ones	Footsteps that never stop; a faint chime

Old One Crossing event (Proposal detail): - 15 s warning: the ground hums, wildlife on the path moves aside,

the path shows as a faint line on the minimap. - The Old One walks a fixed path chosen from 2–3 per map, always crossing the centre line, at 1.5 m/s. - It ignores combat and can't be harmed or blocked; it passes through Bramble Walls, Ossuary and Living Wall without breaking them. - Its blessing (×2 spread within 25 m) favours neither side.

Production note: horizon Old Ones are impostor cards or very low-poly meshes (under 3,000 triangles), animated with a slow vertex sway. Crossing versions are full assets but reuse a lineage's Stage 3 rig scaled up, with a dedicated walk cycle.

Part 4 — Bestiary I: Four-Legged and Two-Legged Creatures

Stat blocks follow the format in Part 1 (§1.3). **Health, damage, speed, group, cores, SAP and key numbers are Spec** (`spec/04`); Phase 1 values. Sizes, behaviour states, telegraphs, animation, audio and look are **Proposal**.

Shared states (Idle, Alert, Flee, Engage, Leash, Recover, Dead, Converted) are defined in §1.9. Each creature lists only what differs.

Four-legged creatures

#1 Mossback Grazer

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Passive, herd of 4
Habitat · maps	Rootwilds · Ashfall Crossing (south plain), Breathing Canopy
Affinity	Verdant (+25% cores)
Size	2.4 m at the shoulder, 4.2 m long; a broad, slow herbivore with a mossy back like a hillside
Health · damage · speed	900 · none · 3.5 m/s
Cores · respawn	45 each · 90 s
Weak point	Soft throat under the jaw, front 90°, 0.18 × height
Key mechanic	Grazing on an enemy cell adds **5% uproot progress/s** (~20 s per cell). **Herding:** a player within 6 m behind the herd pushes it forward at 3.5 m/s

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Graze	Default	Moves cell to cell at 0.8 m/s, head down; prefers cells with the most grass. Grazing an enemy-owned cell erodes it
Herded	A player within 6 m behind the herd's centre, inside a 90° cone	The herd walks away from the player at 3.5 m/s, keeping formation (2 m spacing)
Startle	Damage to any member	All four trot 15 m away, then resume grazing
Territorial (Bloom only)	A Calf harmed	Spec: Grazers attack for 45 damage every 1.2 s for 60 s

Counter-play: herd it onto enemy nodes instead of killing it; it's worth more alive as a slow siege tool. Defenders kill or push it back.

Animation set: graze loop, walk, trot, startle, herd-walk (head up, glancing back), territorial charge (Bloom), death (kneels, lies down, moss spreads).

Audio: low lowing, tearing grass, heavy soft footfalls; a rumbling bellow when startled.

Look: grey-green hide, moss and small ferns growing on the back, wide flat horns swept back. Grazed cells show bitten-down roots or Glaze.

Blighted — Glassback Grazer (Spec): grazing adds **Blight** progress (5%/s) on neutral or Wildborn cells. Moss replaced by glass shards; its back glitters.

#2 Ashfang

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Predator, pack of 3 (Ash Turn: 4)
Habitat · maps	Ashen Steppe · Ashfall Crossing (south and north plains), The Ash Sea
Affinity	Thornrunner
Size	1.3 m at the shoulder, 2.2 m long; lean grey canid with an ash-crusted

Field	Value
	mane
Health · damage · interval · speed	700 · 50 · 1.0 s · 7.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	50 each · 90 s
Weak point	Flank behind the ribs, left and right 90°, 0.2 × height
Key mechanic	Hunts any player **below 30% Health within 40 m**; +30% damage to them

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Patrol	Default	The pack trots a 30 m loop around its den, nose down
Stalk	A player below 30% Health within 40 m	Splits into a fan (one ahead, two flanking) and closes at 5 m/s, low to the ground
Hunt	Within 10 m of the wounded target	Sprints at 7 m/s; bites with +30% damage
Defend	Attacked by a healthy player	Normal Engage; flees at 25% Health
Lose interest	The target heals above 45%, or reaches a held Hub with Defense Level 3+	Returns to Patrol

Attacks

Attack	Telegraph	Wind-up	Area	Damage	Cooldown
Bite	Head drops, lips curl, snarl	0.4 s	Melee 2 m	50 (65 vs. wounded)	1.0 s
Leap bite	Crouch, hind legs bunch	0.5 s	6 m lunge	60	6 s

Counter-play: don't retreat through the steppe alone at low Health; heal first, or travel with a brood-mate. A pack chasing a wounded enemy can be followed to find them.

Animation set: trot, sprint, stalk-crawl, bite, leap bite, howl (pack call), flinch, flee, death.

Audio: a dry, husky howl to start a hunt; pants and snarls; paws in ash.

Look: grey fur matted with ash, pale yellow eyes, a ridge of stiff mane. Readable silhouette: lean, low, ears flat when hunting.

Blighted — Shardfang (Spec): when one is hit, the whole pack aggroes. Glass shards in the mane; the pack moves in perfect step. **Regional:** Frostfang (Rimewastes; bites slow 25% for 2 s), Cinderfang (Cinderveil; pawprints burn 15/s for 3 s).

#3 Stonehide Ox

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Territorial, solo
Habitat · maps	Spirecliffs · Ashfall Crossing (Built: one per side at (±40, −12))
Affinity	Titan
Size	3.6 m at the shoulder, 5.5 m long; a rock-plated bovine
Health · damage · interval · speed	3,500 · 140 · 1.5 s · 4.0 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	160 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	Exposed belly seam, visible from the sides when it rears for a Charge; otherwise the soft nape (rear 90°)
Key mechanic	**Charge:** 25 m line at 10 m/s, 200 damage, **knockdown 1.0 s** to everything hit, creatures included; cooldown 10 s

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Graze	Default	Grazes slowly within 8 m of its rock
Warn	A player within 15 m	Paws the ground, snorts (2 s); does nothing else unless the player stays or attacks
Engage	Attacked, or a player stays inside 15 m for 4 s	Gores in melee; uses Charge when the target is 8–25 m away
Charge	Cooldown ready and target in range	Lowers horns, a 0.8 s wind-up, then a straight line; doesn't steer
Stun self	Charge ends in a wall or a large rock	Dazed 1.5 s; weak point exposed from all sides

Attacks

Attack	Telegraph	Wind-up	Area	Damage	Cooldown
Gore	Head swings back	0.5 s	Melee 3 m, 90° cone	140	1.5 s
Charge	Line decal 25 m, fills over the wind-up; dust plumes from the hooves	0.8 s	25 m × 3 m line	200 + knockdown 1.0 s	10 s

Counter-play: stand between it and an enemy, then step aside: the Charge hits everything in its path. Bait it into rocks to daze it.

Animation set: graze, paw-warn, gore, charge wind-up, charge run, dazed, flinch, death (topples like a rockslide).

Audio: grinding breath, stone plates clacking; a bellow and thundering hooves for the Charge.

Look: stone plates over a grey hide, moss in the cracks, horns like broken columns. Charge leaves a line of churned earth for 10 s.

Blighted — Obsidian Ox (Spec): Charge leaves Glaze: −20% speed for Wildborn for 10 s.

#4 Glimmerfox

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Skittish, solo
Habitat · maps	Rootwilds · Breathing Canopy, Ashfall Crossing (Built: 4 per side)
Affinity	Thornrunner
Size	0.6 m at the shoulder; a slender fox with a shimmering coat
Health · speed	150 · 8.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	20 · 45 s
Key mechanic	**Invisible after 2 s still.** Killing it **reveals enemies within 15 m for 6 s** (Thornrunner kill: 25 m)

Behaviour: sits still and fades (a heat-shimmer remains at 5 m). Flees at 12 m on a zig-zag path, stopping behind cover to fade again. A careful observer sees the shimmer.

Counter-play: worth hunting before a fight for the reveal. A Thornrunner kill gives a 25 m reveal, a strong pre-fight scouting tool.

Animation set: sit, fade (shader), zig-zag run, pounce-play, death (a burst of light motes). **Audio:** a soft yip; a chime when it fades back in. **Look:** pale grey coat with a pearly shimmer; amber eyes that stay visible for 0.3 s after it fades. **Blighted — Glintfox (Spec):** its reveal shows Wildborn only.

#5 Marrowhound

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Scavenger, pair
Habitat · maps	Bone Flats · The Elder Ribs, The Skull Basin
Affinity	Bonespire
Size	1.5 m at the shoulder, 2.4 m long; a long-jawed hyena-like hound with bone plates
Health · damage · speed	800 · 45 · 6.5 m/s
Cores · respawn	50 each · 90 s
Weak point	Swollen belly (its hoard), sides 90°
Key mechanic	Eats dropped cores within 20 m at **40 cores/s**, holds up to **300**, drops all on death

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Scavenge	Default	Wanders between bone nests and recent fight sites
Feed	Dropped cores within 20 m	Runs to them and eats; its belly visibly swells (three sizes: 0, 1–150, 151–300)
Retreat	Damaged while carrying cores	Runs toward the nearest bone nest; fights only if cornered
Engage	Attacked while empty	Normal

Attacks: Bite (0.4 s wind-up, 45 damage, 1.2 s) · Drag-bite (0.6 s crouch, 60, pulls 2 m, 8 s cooldown).

Counter-play: after a fight, race it to the dropped cores; a full Marrowhound is a 300-core piñata that runs. Bonespires kill it efficiently from range.

Animation set: trot, sniff, gulp-feed loop, belly-swell (blend shape), retreat lope, bite, death (cores burst out). **Audio:** cackling yelps, crunching, a satisfied grunt per gulp. **Look:** pale hide over bone plates, long jaws, glowing core light visible through the belly when full. **Blighted — Murmurhound (Spec):** delivers eaten cores to the nearest Blightborn within 60 m, running at 8 m/s.

#6 Duskmane

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Predator, solo
Habitat · maps	Hollow Mire · Breathing Canopy (the mire)
Affinity	Hollow
Size	1.8 m at the shoulder, 3.4 m long; a big cat with a mane of drifting dark fur
Health · damage · speed	2,600 · 130 · 5.5 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	150 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	Base of the skull, rear 120°
Key mechanic	Stealthed in fog. **Pounce** from 12 m: 180 damage + **stun 0.8 s**, cooldown 10 s; targets **lone** players (no ally within 15 m). Drops a **Void Pelt**: +10% Control for 60 s (Hollow: +15%)

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Prowl	Default	Moves through fog banks, stealthed (visible within 6 m as a darker patch)
Stalk	A lone player within 25 m	Circles to the player's rear at 3 m/s
Pounce	Within 12 m behind the target	A 0.5 s crouch (a low growl is the tell), then leaps
Maul	After the pounce	Claws at 130 per 1.5 s; disengages if a second player comes within 10 m
Withdraw	Two players near, or below 40% Health	Fades back into fog and resets stalking

Counter-play: don't walk the mire alone; listen for the growl; turn and Evade at the crouch. Killing it gives the Void Pelt, a strong Control buff for Hollow.

Animation set: prowl, crouch-growl, pounce, maul, withdraw, roar, death (fades to fog). **Audio:** near-silent footsteps, a low growl 0.5 s before the pounce, a coughing roar. **Look:** dark grey-violet fur, a mane that drifts like smoke, eyes that catch light. **Blighted — Hushmane:** cloaks in whispers instead of fog.

#7 Burrowtusk

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Territorial, solo
Habitat · maps	Underroot · The Nerve, Ashfall Crossing (tunnel mouths)
Affinity	Brawler
Size	1.6 m at the shoulder, 2.8 m long; a boar-like digger with spade tusks
Health · damage · speed	1,000 · 55 · 5.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	50 · 90 s
Weak point	Rump, rear 90°
Key mechanic	Digs a tunnel between two nodes up to 80 m apart; lasts **60 s**; one every 120 s; **1.5 s** to travel through

Behaviour: roots around a tunnel mouth. Every 120 s it digs: 3 s of churning earth, then two mouths open (shown on the minimap to everyone). Anyone can use the tunnel. If attacked, it charges (tusk sweep, 0.5 s wind-up, 55 damage, knockback 2 m).

Counter-play: a temporary flank route that both teams see. Kill it to stop new tunnels near your base; protect it if its tunnels favour you.

Animation set: root-snuffle, dig (3 s), emerge, charge, tusk sweep, death. **Audio:** snorts, scraping earth, a rumble under the ground while it digs. **Look:** bristly brown-grey hide caked with soil, wide spade tusks, tiny eyes. **Blighted — Glassdigger:** its tunnels are lined with Blight (cosmetic; Blightborn hear the whisper inside).

#8 Greyback Colossus (Apex)

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	IV · Apex (peaceful unless attacked), solo
Habitat · maps	Ashen Steppe · Ashfall Crossing (joins the Grey Migration in Phase 3)
Affinity	Titan
Size	**22 m at the shoulder, 48 m long** (Proposal); a mountain-sized grazer. Its back is a walkable plateau
Health · speed	30,000 · 2.5 m/s
Attack	**Stomp 300, radius 6 m, every 6 s**
Cores · SAP	400 + 100 SAP (split)
Spawn	Once per phase from Phase 3, max 2 per match (Spec)
Weak points	Four knee joints (two front, two rear), each 0.12 × height, visible from the side; ×1.5
Key mechanic	Its back is a **3-cell moving node**: 4 s root channel; Inaccessible while it stands in enemy-only territory. **Reached by its tail ramp**

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Migrate	Default	Walks the Migration road north → south (or reverse), 2.5 m/s, never stops
Stomp	Any player under or beside it (within 6 m of a foot)	Lifts a foot (1.2 s wind-up, a circular decal under the foot), stomps 300 in r 6 m
Shrug	Players on its back while it's been damaged in the last 10 s	Every 15 s: a 2.0 s rumble, then a shake that knocks players on the back 4 m (not off)
Enraged	Below 30% Health	Stomps every 4 s; walks 3.2 m/s

The back node. Three cells on its back are a single node that travels with it. Whoever holds it gains territory that crosses the whole map. The tail is a 12 m ramp (1.2 m wide strip of fur and moss) that anyone can climb at walking speed. The back is 6 m above the ground at the tail and 20 m at the shoulders.

Counter-play: root its back early in its walk so your node passes through enemy lines; kill it for the 400 split cores; fight on its back for the high ground.

Animation set: walk cycle (very slow, every step a shudder), foot-lift stomp, shrug, head-lower graze (cosmetic), death (kneels, then lies down over 6 s, becoming a hill that fades after 60 s).

Audio: each step is a deep thud felt within 60 m; low, long moans; grass and ash pouring off its sides.

Look: grey fur matted with ash and grass, a back like a meadow with boulders, tusks like fallen trees. Birds ride on it.

Blighted — The Starbacked (Spec): its back node starts **blighted**; a meteor shard grows out of its shoulders.

#45 Mossback Calves

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Passive; 1–2 per Mossback herd, **Bloom only**
Size	1.0 m at the shoulder
Health · speed · cores	200 · 3.5 m/s · 15
Key mechanic	Harming one makes its herd **territorial for 60 s**: the Grazers attack for 45 damage every 1.2 s

Behaviour: stays within 4 m of an adult; bleats and runs to the herd's centre when a player is within 8 m. **Counter-play:** don't farm calves near a herd unless you want a fight with four Grazers. **Animation set:** follow, hop-play, bleat, run-to-herd, death. **Audio:** high bleats. **Look:** a tiny Grazer with a soft moss fuzz instead of a back-garden. **Blighted form (Proposal) — Glass Calves:** a thin glass frost on the fuzz; harming one makes a Glassback herd territorial toward Wildborn only.

#49 Cinder Salamander

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Skittish; 4–6 per map
Habitat · maps	Cinderveil · Fevermouth, The Glass Forest
Affinity	Titan
Size	0.8 m tall, 3.0 m long
Health · speed	600 · 5.0 m/s (swims in lava)
Cores · respawn	45 · 90 s
Key mechanic	Dives into lava at 10 m. On death leaves a **cooling-rock stepping stone** (3 m) for **45 s** (Titan kill: 90 s)

Behaviour: basks on cooling rock at the edge of a lava channel; dives when anything comes within 10 m; resurfaces 20 m along the channel after 6 s. Killing it on the lava creates the stepping stone exactly where it died. **Counter-play:** use ranged attacks while it basks; time the kill to create a shortcut across a lava channel. **Animation set:** bask, look-around, dive, swim, surface, death (stiffens and cools to stone). **Audio:** a hiss, a soft plop into lava, bubbling. **Look:** slick black skin with glowing orange veins that brighten as it dives. **Blighted — Obsidian Salamander:** leaves a glass stepping stone only Blightborn can use.

#53 Heartwood Elk (special Apex)

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	IV · Passive; **invulnerable**; 0–1 per match
Habitat · maps	Heartwood · any map's Heartwood grove, rarely
Affinity	Verdant
Size	**11 m at the shoulder**, antlers spanning 14 m; taller than a Stage 3 Titan
Speed	2.0 m/s
Cores	0
Key mechanic	In a Heartwood grove, roots spread **×3 for 30 s** for whoever holds the grove. Ignores combat; can't be infected

Behaviour: walks a slow loop through the grove for 30 s, then fades into the trees. Bodies, walls and Ultimates pass through it. **Look:** antlers like living trees with leaves and flowers; warm amber light under its fur. **Audio:** deep, slow breaths; a soft hum. Every player hears a single low horn when it appears. **Blighted form: none**. It is the only creature the Murmur has never touched.

Two-legged creatures

#9 Strays

See Part 3, §3.1.

#10 Strider Crane

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Skittish flock of 6–8
Habitat · maps	Hollow Mire · Breathing Canopy (mire), The Heron Reach
Size	1.8 m tall on long legs; 2.6 m wingspan
Health · speed · cores	120 · 9.0 m/s (flies) · 10 each
Key mechanic	Startled at **10 m** (Hollow, Thornrunner: **5 m**). Startling **reveals the startler for 4 s** to everyone

Behaviour: stands in the shallows. A player moving faster than walking speed within 10 m (5 m for Hollow and Thornrunner) startles the whole flock: they lift with a roar of wings, circle once over the startler, and land 60 m away

after 12 s. **Counter-play:** walk, don't run, through the mire; or startle them on purpose to check where enemies are (the reveal shows *whoever* startled them). **Animation set:** stand, preen, step, take-off, flap loop, glide, land, death. **Audio:** a rattling alarm call; the wing roar is audible at 60 m. **Look:** grey-blue plumage, black legs, a crest that lifts when alarmed. **Blighted — Shard Crane:** its alarm call is a ringing chime; same reveal.

#11 Rootwalker

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Territorial, solo, on a neutral node
Habitat · maps	Rootwilds · Breathing Canopy
Affinity	Verdant
Size	3.2 m tall; a tree-like biped with root feet
Health · damage · interval · speed	1,200 · 60 · 1.6 s · 3.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	60 · 90 s
Weak point	Knot in the trunk's back, rear 120°
Key mechanic	The node **can't be rooted while it lives**. **Calm** (Verdant only): 3 s channel, removes it for 120 s without a fight; gives 60 cores

Behaviour: stands on the node's core, swaying. Attacks anyone who channels Root on its node or hits it. Never leaves the node (leash = node radius). **Attacks:** Branch sweep (0.6 s, 60, 3 m arc) · Root grip (0.8 s, ground decal r 2 m, roots the target 0.8 s, 12 s cooldown). **Counter-play:** a Verdant calms it in 3 s; anyone else has to fight it, which is slow and noisy. **Animation set:** sway idle, sweep, root grip, calm (kneels and sinks into the ground), death (topples). **Audio:** creaking wood, a deep groan when attacked, soft rustle when calmed. **Blighted — Lattice Walker:** guards **Blightborn** nodes instead of neutral ones (can't be calmed).

#12 Knucklebrute

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Territorial, solo
Habitat · maps	Spirecliffs · The Frozen Falls, The Wind Bridge seed
Affinity	Brawler
Size	3.4 m tall; a gorilla-like brawler with stone knuckles
Health · damage · speed	3,000 · 160 · 5.0 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	170 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	A crack in the brow plate, front 90°
Key mechanic	Challenges the first player within **20 m**. Winning **alone** (no ally damage) gives **Momentum: +10% damage and +10% speed for 30 s**

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Display	Default	Sits on a boulder; beats its chest every 20 s
Challenge	First player within 20 m	Roars, beats its chest twice (1.5 s) and charges that player only
Duel	Challenged player engaged	Ignores everyone else unless they damage it (which voids the solo reward)
Brawl	A second player damages it	Attacks whoever hit it most recently

Attacks: Hook (0.5 s, 160, 3 m) · Double slam (0.8 s, ground decal r 4 m, 180, stagger 0.4 s, 10 s) · Leap (0.7 s crouch, 10 m, 140, 14 s). **Counter-play:** a Brawler or Titan takes the 1v1 for Momentum; others leave it alone. **Animation set:** chest beat, roar, charge, hook, double slam, leap, stagger, death. **Audio:** chest drums audible at 50 m, grunting roars. **Blighted — Geode Brute (Spec):** weak point moves to a glowing geode in its back (an easy Bonespire shot).

#13 Hollowmonk

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Passive, solo
Habitat · maps	Hollow Mire · Breathing Canopy
Affinity	Hollow
Size	2.6 m tall, gaunt; robed in hanging moss
Health · speed	900 · 3.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	55 · 90 s
Key mechanic	**Aura 12 m: all capture and uproot progress paused**

Behaviour: stands still on or beside a node; drifts slowly away from damage (never fights). The aura shows as a faint grey ring on the ground and a muted soundscape. **Counter-play:** kill it before trying to capture nearby; or leave it alive next to your own node as a natural defence. **Animation set:** stand-meditate, drift, flinch, death (crumbles to moss). **Audio:** none, except a low hum inside the aura; sound inside the ring is muffled 30%. **Blighted — Whisper Monk (Spec):** pauses only Wildborn progress.

#14 Spurlark

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Skittish, solo
Habitat · maps	Ashen Steppe · Ashfall Crossing (Built: 1 per side at (±58, 30))
Affinity	Thornrunner
Size	1.2 m tall; a sprinting ground bird with spurred legs
Health · speed · cores	160 · **10.0 m/s** · **40** (double)
Key mechanic	Hard to catch; flees on a curving path

Behaviour: pecks in the grass; flees at 12 m on an S-curve, changing direction every 1.5 s. **Counter-play:** cut it off rather than chase; ranged attacks and Thorn Dash are best. **Animation set:** peck, alert, sprint, hop-turn, death. **Audio:** a sharp trill. **Blighted — Glass Lark:** leaves glittering trails that reveal its path.

#15 Bonewright

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Territorial, solo + 3 totems
Habitat · maps	Bone Flats · The Elder Ribs
Affinity	Bonespire
Size	3.0 m tall; a lanky biped that wears bones like armour
Health · damage · speed	2,400 · 120 · 3.5 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	150 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Key mechanic	Totems: **400 Health** each, within 15 m; each gives wildlife nearby +10% damage and −10% damage taken (stacks to 3). **The Bonewright takes −60% damage while any totem stands.** Rebuilds one totem every 20 s

Behaviour: tends its totems; when attacked, retreats behind them and throws bone shards (0.5 s, 20 m, 120). Starts rebuilding a fallen totem 20 s after it falls (a 3 s build animation; interrupted by damage). **Counter-play:** break all three totems first (they're stationary, 400 Health each), then burst it before a rebuild. **Animation set:** build totem, throw, retreat, idle-arrange bones, death (collapses into a bone pile). **Audio:** clacking bones, a rattling hiss. **Look:** totems are 2.5 m stacks of skulls and vertebrae with an amber glow inside. **Blighted — Glasswright:** crystal totems that buff Blighted creatures.

#16 The Old Tall (Apex)

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	IV · Apex wanderer, solo
Habitat · maps	Any · patron event on any map; The Elder Ribs
Size	**16 m tall**; a towering, ancient biped with long arms and a lichen-hung body
Health · speed	25,000 · 2.0 m/s
Attack	**Kick 350, cone 6 m**
Cores · SAP	400 + 100 SAP (split)
Key mechanic	Walks Hub to Hub. **Tension ×3** within 30 m. The Planet Pulse version **hunts Blightborn for 45 s**, then leaves (no kill required)

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Wander	Default (natural spawn)	Walks Hub to Hub at 2 m/s; stops 20 s at each
Defend	Attacked	Kicks attackers within 6 m (1.0 s wind-up, cone decal); every 12 s a two-handed sweep (1.4 s, 10 m arc, 280, knockback 5 m)
Hunt (event)	Planet Pulse "The Old Tall wakes"	Targets the nearest Blightborn, walking at 3 m/s; ignores Wildborn unless hit; leaves after 45 s

Counter-play: a Tension accelerator: fights near it trigger events fast. Blightborn scatter during its hunt; Wildborn fight beside it. **Animation set:** walk, look-around, kick, sweep, kneel-rest, leave (walks off the map edge), death. **Audio:** creaking like an old tree, low hoots. **Blighted — The Tall Hush:** raises Tension only on Wildborn borders.

#44 Seedcaller

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Skittish, solo
Habitat · maps	Any (Season 4 Bloom onward)
Size	2.2 m tall; slender, long-fingered, seed pods hanging from its arms
Health · speed · cores	700 · 6.0 m/s · 45
Key mechanic	Regrows **1 neutral cell per 10 s** along its path, even from Scald

Behaviour: walks a wandering route between neutral and burnt cells, planting. Flees at 12 m. Rally it (Wildborn) to make it walk where you choose for 90 s. **Animation set:** walk-plant, scatter seeds, flee, death. **Audio:** soft rattles, a flute-like call. **Blighted form (Proposal) — Shardcaller:** plants glass; cells it walks over become neutral but can't be rooted for 30 s.

#47 Drift Owlbear

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Territorial; 2–3 drifts per map
Habitat · maps	Rimewastes · The Sleeper, The Frozen Falls
Affinity	Brawler
Size	3.8 m tall standing; white-furred, hooked beak, bear shoulders
Health · damage · speed	3,400 · 170 · 5.0 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	170 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	The back of the neck, rear 90°
Key mechanic	Wakes when a player steps within **3 m** of its drift (Rime Turn: 1.5 m); rampages **20 s** on the nearest creature, then sleeps if unharmed

Behaviour: asleep under a too-round drift with a frost plume. On waking: an explosive 1.0 s rise (snow burst, 40 damage r 3 m), then 20 s attacking the nearest creature of any team. If nobody damages it in the last 5 s of the rampage, it digs back in. **Attacks:** Swipe (0.5 s, 170, 3 m) · Beak lunge (0.6 s, 6 m, 150) · Roar (1.0 s, r 8 m, slows 30% 2 s, 15 s cooldown). **Counter-play:** read the frost plumes and walk around them, or lure enemies across one. **Animation set:** sleep (breathing under snow), wake burst, swipe, lunge, roar, dig in, death. **Audio:** a deep snore under the snow; an explosive roar. **Blighted — Glass-furred Owlbear:** its drift is Glaze; it wakes only for Wildborn.

#50 Ash Vulture

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Scavenger; 3–8 per map (Ash Turn ×2)
Habitat · maps	Cinderveil · Fevermouth, The Glass Forest
Affinity	Bonespire
Size	1.1 m tall, 3.2 m wingspan
Health · speed · cores	150 · 8.0 m/s (flies) · 15
Key mechanic	Circles any spot with combat in the last 10 s; lands only on bodies

Behaviour: soars at 25–35 m. Within 10 s of combat anywhere, 2–4 vultures circle the spot (a readable sign of a fight). After a death, they land on the body and pick up any cores still lying within 3 m (5 per second) unless scared off (a player within 6 m). **Counter-play:** look up to find fights; shoot landed vultures to recover cores. **Animation set:** soar, circle, land, peck, hop, take-off, death (falls). **Audio:** rough croaks, heavy wingbeats on hot air. **Blighted — Glass Vulture:** circles only above Wildborn who are about to die.

#52 Shard Gull

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Skittish flock of 6–10
Habitat · maps	Shattered Coast · Shard Reef
Affinity	Thornrunner
Size	0.6 m tall, 1.4 m wingspan
Health · damage · speed	120 · 10 · 8.0 m/s (flies)
Cores	15 + a **Starshard** (30 cores; Thornrunner: 40)
Key mechanic	Mobs anything within 8 m of its nest

Behaviour: dives into the surf for glass; returns to its cliff nest. Anyone within 8 m of the nest is mobbed by the flock for 6 s (10 damage per peck, ~4 pecks/s total). **Animation set:** dive, surface, fly, nest, mob-swoop, death (the shard falls and glints). **Audio:** shrill cries; glass clinking in the beak. **Blighted — Hush Gull:** silent; its shards are larger (Proposal: 40 cores).

Part 5 — Bestiary II: Six-Legged, Eight-Legged and Insects

Same format and labels as Part 4. Numbers in the stat tables are **Spec**; behaviour, telegraphs, sizes, animation, audio and look are **Proposal**.

Six-legged creatures (non-insect)

#17 Sixhorn Ram

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Territorial, solo or pair
Habitat · maps	Spirecliffs · The Frozen Falls, Ram's Crossing seed
Affinity	Titan
Size	1.7 m at the shoulder, 2.6 m long; six legs, three pairs of curled horns
Health · damage · speed	1,000 · 50 + **knockback 6 m** · 6.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	55 · 90 s
Weak point	Underbelly between the middle legs, sides 90° when it rears
Key mechanic	Knockback can push players **off ledges**

Behaviour: grazes on ledges. Warns at 10 m (stamps, lowers horns 1 s). Rams anyone who stays. Prefers to charge when the target has a drop behind it. **Attacks:** Head-butt (0.6 s wind-up, horns lowered, a short line decal 4 m; 50 + 6 m knockback; 6 s) · Kick (0.4 s, 40, rear only). **Counter-play:** fight it away from edges; Titans are immune to the knockback (Immovable). **Animation set:** graze, stamp-warn, head-butt, rear, kick, death. **Audio:** horn clacks that echo off cliffs, a bleating bellow. **Blighted — Shardhorn Ram:** crystal horns; knockback longer (Proposal: 8 m).

#18 Trundleback

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Passive, solo
Habitat · maps	Bone Flats · The Elder Ribs, The Skull Basin
Affinity	Bonespire
Size	2.8 m tall at the shell's crown, 5.0 m long; a six-legged armoured tortoise
Health · speed	4,000 · 2.0 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	180 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Key mechanic	**Immune** except its **underside** weak point: hittable from a 60° cone at ground level behind it, or from anywhere while **flipped**. Any knockback or stagger from a Titan or Brawler flips it for **4 s**. Its shell is a **3 m platform**

Behaviour: wanders slowly between bone fields; ignores players entirely, including those standing on its shell. When flipped, legs flail; it rights itself after 4 s with a 0.5 s roll. **Counter-play:** a Titan's Quake Slam or a Brawler's uppercut flips it, then the team bursts the belly. Players use the shell as moving high ground (a Bonespire's perch). **Animation set:** walk, graze, flipped-flail loop, right-itself roll, withdraw head, death (shell stays as cover for 30 s). **Audio:** slow scraping steps; a hollow boom when flipped. **Look:** bone-white shell plates in a hexagon pattern; the underside is soft and amber-veined. **Blighted — Geode Shell (Spec):** underside weak point visible from 15 m (it glows cyan through the plates).

#19 Lantern Lizard

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Passive, solo

Field	Value
Habitat · maps	Underroot · Ashfall Crossing (tunnels), The Nerve
Size	0.4 m tall, 1.2 m long
Health · speed · cores	150 · 4.0 m/s · 10
Key mechanic	Any player within **8 m** appears on the **enemy** minimap

Behaviour: clings to tunnel walls and ceilings; its throat glows. Doesn't flee. **Counter-play:** kill it before moving through a tunnel, or leave it as an alarm on your own flank. **Animation set:** cling idle, crawl, throat pulse, death (light fades). **Audio:** a faint ticking. **Look:** its throat sac glows amber; the light pulses brighter when a player is in range. **Blighted — Coldlight Lizard (Spec):** violet light; reveals Wildborn only. **Regional — Glow Lizard (Spec):** deep caves; reveal radius 14 m.

#20 Gravel Skink

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Skittish, 2–4
Habitat · maps	Ashen Steppe · Ashfall Crossing (Built: 2 per side + 1 centre), The Ash Sea
Size	0.3 m tall, 0.9 m long
Health · speed · cores	180 · 6.0 m/s · 15
Key mechanic	Burrows for 5 s when a player comes within 6 m

Behaviour: basks on flat stones; burrows at 6 m (a puff of gravel), resurfaces 5 s later up to 8 m away. Pure, simple income for Stage 1 players. **Animation set:** bask, head-bob, burrow, emerge, scurry, death. **Audio:** a gravel rattle. **Blighted — Glass Skink:** burrows into Blight, leaving a trail.

#21 Hexmaw

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Predator, ambush, solo
Habitat · maps	Hollow Mire · Breathing Canopy (mire edges)
Affinity	Hollow
Size	Body 3.0 m across, hidden in mud; six tentacle-legs up to 10 m
Health · damage	2,800 · **60/s while holding**
Cores · SAP · respawn	160 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	The mouth, exposed from any angle while it drags a victim
Key mechanic	**Drag:** grabs a player within 10 m and pulls at 2 m/s toward its mouth; grip broken by **400 damage to the tentacle** (by an ally) or **any stagger** on the Hexmaw; cooldown 12 s

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Hidden	Default	Submerged; only slow ripples and two eye-bumps show (the world tell)
Strike	A player within 10 m	A tentacle bursts out (0.4 s, splash decal) and grabs
Drag	Grab lands	Pulls the victim toward its mouth at 2 m/s; bites for 60/s once they arrive
Release	Grip broken or 6 s pass	Submerges for 4 s; moves 8 m

Counter-play: watch the mud for ripples; travel in pairs so someone can cut the tentacle; a Titan's Quake Slam staggers it free. **Animation set:** submerged idle (ripples), tentacle strike, drag loop, bite, release, submerge, death (sinks). **Audio:** bubbling; a wet crack on the strike; a sucking gurgle while dragging. **Blighted — Glassmaw:** hides under Glaze instead of mud.

#22 Sapdrinker

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Passive, solo, on a node
Habitat · maps	Rootwilds · Breathing Canopy
Affinity	Verdant
Size	1.4 m tall, 2.4 m long; a tick-like six-legged drinker with a glassy abdomen that fills with SAP
Health · speed	700 · 2.5 m/s
Cores · respawn	45 · 90 s
Key mechanic	Drains **1 SAP/s** from the team holding its node (Verdant kill: **+30 SAP**)

Behaviour: sits on a node's core with its proboscis in the ground. Its abdomen glows brighter the more it has drained. Defends weakly (kick, 30 damage). **Counter-play:** clear it from your nodes; leave it on enemy nodes. **Animation set:** drink loop, abdomen fill (blend shape), scuttle, kick, death (abdomen bursts in an amber splash). **Audio:** slurping; a soft gurgle. **Blighted — Glowdrinker (Spec):** drains 1 SAP/s from the Wildborn **and adds it** to the Blightborn.

#23 Rimeback Stag

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Skittish, herd of 5
Habitat · maps	Spirecliffs, Rimewastes · The Sleeper, The Frozen Falls
Size	2.0 m at the shoulder; six-legged, frost on the antlers
Health · speed	800 · 8.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	45 each · 90 s
Key mechanic	Killing one starts a **stampede** 25 m: **80 damage + 4 m knockback** to anyone in the path

Behaviour: grazes in a loose herd. When one dies, the others bolt in a straight 25 m line away from the killer (the stampede line shows as a ground decal for 0.6 s before they run). **Counter-play:** kill a stag when the enemy stands in the stampede line. **Animation set:** graze, alert, bolt, stampede run, death. **Audio:** bugling calls; drumming hooves on ice. **Blighted — Glassback Stag:** its stampede leaves Glaze.

#24 Sixfold Wyrm (Apex)

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	IV · Apex, solo
Habitat · maps	Underroot · The Nerve; patron event (Blighted Wyrm) on any map
Affinity	Brawler
Size	6 m tall at the head when raised, **38 m long**; a six-legged serpent-dragon with a spade head
Health · speed	28,000 · 6.0 m/s
Attacks	**Bite 400** · **Tail sweep 250, radius 8 m**
Cores · SAP	400 + 100 SAP (split)
Weak point	The soft throat behind the jaw, front 90°, exposed while it rears for a Bite
Key mechanic	Bursts out at **100 Tension** in that region. **Burrows and resurfaces every 20 s near the loudest player** (lure it). The Murmur Surge version **hunts Wildborn for 45 s**

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Emerge	Spawn, or after a burrow	Ground cracks in a 10 m circle (1.5 s warning), then it bursts up: 150 damage, knock-up 0.6 s to anyone inside
Fight	Above ground	Bites (1.0 s rear-back, cone 60° 6 m, 400) and tail-sweeps (1.2 s coil, ring r 8 m, 250, knockback 4 m, every 10 s)
Burrow	Every 20 s	Dives (2 s), travels underground toward the player with the loudest sound signature in 60 m, emerges near them
Hunt (Murmur Surge)	Event spawn	Targets Wildborn only for 45 s, then burrows away

Counter-play: the loudest player decides where it emerges, so a carrier with 300+ cores or a fresh Stage change

can lure it into the enemy. Stand outside the crack circle. **Animation set:** emerge, rear-bite, tail coil and sweep, burrow dive, underground travel (a moving ridge of earth), roar, death. **Audio:** grinding rock underground (a rumble that moves); a hissing roar. **Blighted — Blighted Wyrm (Spec):** the patron-event version; glass scales, cyan throat.

#41 Cairnshell

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Passive, 2–3
Habitat · maps	Spirecliffs · The Frozen Falls; climbs on Titans as cosmetic
Affinity	Titan
Size	1.5 m tall with its boulder; six-legged hermit creature
Health · speed	1,100 · 2.5 m/s
Cores · respawn	50 · 90 s
Key mechanic	Drops its **boulder** when startled or killed: cover **3 m wide, 1,000 Health**. A Titan can **throw** it 20 m: **150 + 0.5 × P, stun 0.5 s**

Behaviour: carries a boulder on its back. Startled at 6 m or by damage: drops the boulder and scuttles away naked (pale, soft) to find another (40 s). The boulder stays until destroyed. **Counter-play:** create cover where you need it; a Titan picks up the boulder (1.0 s, interact) and throws it. **Animation set:** walk, startle-drop, naked scuttle, re-shell, death. **Audio:** stone scraping; a squeak when startled. **Blighted — Geode Hermit:** wears a meteor shard instead of a boulder.

#46 Emberbark

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Territorial, solo (Season 4)
Habitat · maps	Any map after a Clamor Landfall season
Size	3.2 m tall; a six-legged creature armoured in thick charred bark
Health · damage · speed	3,200 · 140 · 4.0 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	160 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	A sap-filled split in the bark on its back, rear 120°
Key mechanic	Immune to burning; **×2 damage to Clamor creatures**; attacks them first

Behaviour: patrols a 25 m area. If any Clamor creature is within 30 m, it goes for it first, ignoring players unless attacked. Otherwise territorial (warns at 15 m). **Attacks:** Bark slam (0.6 s, 140, 3 m) · Sap spray (0.5 s, cone 5 m, 80, puts out fire on allies; 10 s). **Counter-play:** during a Landfall, lead Clamor creatures to it. **Animation set:** patrol, warn, slam, sap spray, death. **Audio:** cracking bark, a low hum. **Blighted form (Proposal) — Glassbark:** glass-sheathed; attacks Clamor and Wildborn.

#51 Tidal Strider

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Passive; 2–3 at high tide
Habitat · maps	Shattered Coast · Shard Reef
Affinity	Hollow
Size	5.0 m tall on long thin legs; body 3 m across
Health · speed	1,300 · 3.0 m/s (walks on water)
Cores · respawn	55 · 90 s
Key mechanic	Players beneath it (radius 4 m) are hidden from the enemy minimap and from sight beyond 10 m

Behaviour: walks slow loops over the flooded causeways at high tide; stands still on the beach at low tide. Ignores players. **Animation set:** water-walk (feet dimpling the surface), stand, flinch, death (collapses into the water). **Audio:** soft splashes, a low hum. **Blighted — Shard Strider (Spec):** hides Blightborn beneath it, not Wildborn.

Eight-legged creatures

#25 Weavemother

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Territorial, solo
Habitat · maps	Rootwilds · Breathing Canopy (one per map, on a contested node), The Weaver's Hollow
Size	2.4 m tall, legspan 7 m
Health · damage · speed	2,600 · 120 · 4.0 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	150 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	Spinnerets, rear 120°
Key mechanic	Webs a node every **60 s**: **Inaccessible** until **cut (8 s channel)** or **burned** (any burn removes it in 2 s)

Behaviour: lives on a web between trees near a node. Every 60 s it spins over a nearby node (8 s animation; interruptible by 300 damage). Attacks anyone who cuts a web within 20 m. **Attacks:** Bite (0.5 s, 120) · Web shot (0.6 s, 15 m, roots 1.0 s, 12 s). **Counter-play:** burn webs (Cinderfang trails, Kindler fire, Ashwing Moths); kill her to stop it. **Animation set:** spin, hang, drop, bite, web shot, death (curls up). **Audio:** silk singing as it stretches; a hiss. **Look:** grey-banded, velvety; webs glisten with dew (amber at dusk). **Blighted — Glass Weaver (Spec):** webs can't be burned; shattered by 600 damage instead (no channel). **Regional — Rime Weaver (Spec):** webs break on any hit ≥ 150; anyone caught inside is rooted 1.0 s.

#26 Threadlings

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Swarm of 12
Habitat · maps	Rootwilds · Breathing Canopy; spawned by the Eightfold Matron
Affinity	Thornrunner
Size	0.15 m each
Health · damage · speed	40 each · 5 · 5.0 m/s
Cores	24 per swarm
Key mechanic	Each Threadling within 3 m **slows 4%** (max 40%)

Behaviour: drifts across the forest floor as a carpet; swarms anyone who steps into it. **Counter-play:** area damage clears them fast (Quake Slam, Barb Volley, Thornstorm). **Production:** GPU-instanced with vertex animation; the swarm is one AI agent with 12 visual members. **Audio:** a dry rustle. **Blighted — Glassthreads (Spec):** 60 Health each; visible from 30 m (they shine and chime).

#27 Stiltwalker

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Passive, solo or herd
Habitat · maps	Ashen Steppe · Ashfall Crossing, The Sleeper, The Ash Sea
Size	**8 m tall** on eight thin legs; body 4 m across
Health · speed	1,500 · 3.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	60 · 90 s
Key mechanic	Players beneath it (radius 4 m) are hidden from the enemy minimap and from sight beyond 10 m

Behaviour: browses tall grass slowly; ignores players. Its slow route makes it a moving hide. **Counter-play:** walk under it to cross open ground unseen; check under Stiltwalkers when hunting. **Animation set:** stilt-walk, browse, flinch, death (folds legs and settles). **Audio:** a slow creaking; a whale-like low moan. **Blighted — Shardstilt (Spec):** hides Blightborn beneath it, not Wildborn.

#28 Mire Scuttler

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Territorial, 1–2
Habitat · maps	Hollow Mire · Breathing Canopy; tideline on Shard Reef
Affinity	Brawler
Size	1.2 m tall, 2.4 m wide; crab-like, huge armoured front claws
Health · damage · speed	1,000 · 60 · 4.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	55 · 90 s
Weak point	The soft back, rear 120°
Key mechanic	**−90% damage from the front 180°** (exceeds the cap by design)

Behaviour: always turns to face its attacker (turn rate 180°/s, so fast flankers get behind it). **Attacks:** Claw pinch (0.5 s, 60) · Claw slam (0.7 s, 3 m arc, 80, stagger 0.3 s, 8 s). **Counter-play:** one player holds its attention from the front while another hits its back. **Animation set:** sidestep, claw guard, pinch, slam, turn, death. **Audio:** clicking claws, bubbling. **Blighted — Shard Scuttler (Spec):** a weak-point hit breaks a claw: front reduction falls to −45%. **Regional — Tide Scuttler (Spec):** heals 5% max Health/s while in surf.

#29 Glasslegs

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Predator, solo
Habitat · maps	Underroot · The Nerve, ice caves
Affinity	Hollow
Size	1.6 m tall, legspan 4 m; translucent
Health · damage · speed	800 · **70 first strike + root 0.5 s, then 50** · 6.0 m/s
Cores · respawn	55 · 90 s
Key mechanic	**Invisible after 1.5 s still**; revealed only on its strike

Behaviour: waits still in a corridor. World tell: a faint refraction, like heat haze, visible within 5 m, and a single glint when a light source crosses it. **Counter-play:** move with a Lantern Lizard nearby (light shows it); area attacks in corridors. **Animation set:** still (shader), strike, chase, flee, death (shatters into clear fragments). **Audio:** none until the strike; a glassy click on the strike. **Blighted — Truly Glass (Spec):** silent; no attack sound.

#30 Tendril Crawler

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Predator, solo
Habitat · maps	Hollow Mire · Breathing Canopy
Affinity	Hollow
Size	2.2 m tall, 6 m tentacle reach; a land-octopus
Health · damage · speed	3,000 · **50/s while holding** · 3.5 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	170 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	The beak under the mantle, front 90°, exposed while holding
Key mechanic	Grabs **two** players within 8 m: **stun 1.5 s**; cooldown 14 s

Behaviour: camouflaged against tree roots. When two players are within 8 m, it raises two tentacles (0.7 s wind-up; two line decals) and grabs both. **Counter-play:** spread out near it; a third player bursts its beak while it holds. **Animation set:** camouflaged idle, double grab, hold loop, release, crawl, death. **Audio:** wet suckers, a low gurgle. **Blighted — Lattice Crawler (Spec):** grabbed players are Blighted: −10% healing received for 8 s.

#31 Bone Harvestman

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Passive, solo
Habitat · maps	Bone Flats · The Elder Ribs (around the ribs)
Affinity	Bonespire
Size	2.0 m tall on long thin legs
Health · speed	900 · 3.5 m/s
Cores · respawn	40 · 90 s
Key mechanic	Its nest fills with **1 core every 3 s, up to 80** (4 min). Nest: **300 Health**; anyone breaking it gets the stored cores

Behaviour: carries bones from the flats to its nest, adding one every 30 s. The nest visibly grows in three sizes (0–25, 26–55, 56–80 cores). **Counter-play:** patrol the nests around the Ribs; a full nest is 80 free cores. **Animation set:** walk, carry bone, place bone, flee, death. **Audio:** bones clicking as they're placed; heard as a background sound around the Ribs. **Blighted — Shard Harvestman (Spec):** nests hold Starshards: 100 cores.

#32 Eightfold Matron (Apex)

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	IV · Apex, solo
Habitat · maps	Underroot · Breathing Canopy (cave beneath the centre glade; nest wakes in Phase 3)
Affinity	Thornrunner
Size	**9 m tall, legspan 26 m**
Health · speed	22,000 · 3.0 m/s
Attacks	**Bite 350** · **Web spit: root 1.5 s**
Cores · SAP	400 + 100 SAP (split)
Weak point	The egg-sac under the abdomen, rear 120°
Key mechanic	Spawns a **Threadling swarm every 20 s** (max 4 alive) until she dies

Behaviour

State	Trigger	Does
Nest	Default	Hangs above the cave floor; drops when a player enters the cave
Fight	Players in the cave	Bites (1.0 s, cone 6 m, 350); web spit every 8 s (0.8 s, 25 m projectile, root 1.5 s); a swarm every 20 s
Climb	Below 50% Health	Climbs to the ceiling for 6 s (out of melee range) and spits twice
Enrage	Below 20%	Swarms every 12 s

Counter-play: area damage on the swarms; ranged damage while she climbs; a Thornrunner's affinity gives +25% cores. **Animation set:** hang, drop, bite, spit, lay swarm, climb, ceiling hang, death. **Audio:** a deep chittering; silk creaking; a scream at death. **Blighted — Glass Matron:** spawns Glassthreads.

#48 Hoarfrost Mites

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Swarm of 10; 3–5 swarms per map (Rime: more)
Habitat · maps	Rimewastes · The Sleeper
Affinity	Stillheart
Health · speed · cores	30 each · 2.0 m/s · 15 per swarm
Key mechanic	Leave **slick patches** (radius 6 m, 20 s): **−30% turn rate, momentum slide**. Stillheart is unaffected and gains **+10% speed** on them

Behaviour: drifts across ice; swarms toward the nearest Stillheart within 30 m. **Look:** tiny glints of white light; patches are bright white frost with a sheen. **Audio:** a faint crackle. **Blighted — Shard Mites:** patches whisper; Blightborn don't slip.

Insects

#33 Ember Moth

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Passive swarm of 8
Habitat · maps	Ashen Steppe · Ashfall Crossing (dusk)
Health · speed · cores	60 each · 4.0 m/s (flies) · 16 per swarm
Key mechanic	Drawn within **30 m** of any Stage transformation

Behaviour: flutters over grass at dusk; converges on any transformation and circles the new form for 10 s. **Counter-play:** easy cores for the transformed player; their glow gives away a transformation location. **Look:** small grey moths whose wings glow ember-orange. **Blighted — Glimmer Moth:** drawn to Blightborn transformations. **Regional — Ashwing Moths (Spec):** ignite Embergrass on touch (fire spreads 1 m/s for 10 s).

#34 Siege Beetle

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Territorial, solo
Habitat · maps	Bone Flats · The Elder Ribs
Affinity	Titan
Size	2.6 m tall, 4.0 m long; horned, heavily armoured
Health · damage · speed	3,200 · 130 · 3.5 m/s
Cores · SAP · respawn	170 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	The joint between head and thorax, front 60°, exposed when it lowers its horn
Key mechanic	**40% damage reduction.** Chases its **last attacker**; **200 damage per hit to structures** it touches (final)

Behaviour: chases whoever hit it last, at 3.5 m/s, through anything. If a structure is in its path, it rams it every 1.5 s until it's no longer in the way. **Attacks:** Horn toss (0.6 s, 130, knockback 3 m) · Ram (0.8 s, line 6 m, 160). **Counter-play:** the luring game: hit it, then run past an enemy Hub or Core so it rams through. Defenders hit it last to pull it away. **Animation set:** walk, horn lower, ram, toss, structure ram loop, death. **Audio:** chitinous clacks, a heavy thud on every ram. **Blighted — Shard Beetle:** damages Wildborn structures only. **Regional — Magma Beetle (Spec):** lava trail, 30 damage/s for 4 s, structures included.

#35 Rootworm

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Passive, 1–3 per freshly rooted node
Habitat · maps	Rootwilds · any map with fresh roots
Affinity	Verdant
Health · speed · cores	80 · 2.0 m/s · 10
Key mechanic	A Verdant eating one: **next Root −30% channel**

Behaviour: emerges from a node 5 s after it's rooted (Wildborn) and wriggles for 30 s before burrowing. **Blighted — Shardworm:** emerges from fresh Blight; speeds the next blight-capture.

#36 Thornwasp

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Territorial swarm: nest + 6 wasps
Habitat · maps	Spirecliffs · The Frozen Falls
Affinity	Thornrunner
Health · damage · speed	Nest 800; wasps 30 each · 15/s per wasp · 7.0 m/s
Cores	50 (nest)

Field	Value
Key mechanic	The swarm chases anyone within **10 m** of the nest for **12 s or 40 m**

Behaviour: the nest hangs from a ledge. The swarm pursues the intruder and anyone the intruder runs past (so it can be dragged into enemies). **Counter-play:** run the swarm through the enemy; area damage kills wasps. **Audio:** an angry drone that rises in pitch as it chases. **Blighted — Glasswasp:** swarm chases Wildborn only.

#37 Hush Cicada

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Passive, 3–5
Habitat · maps	Hollow Mire · Breathing Canopy (the mire), The Nerve
Affinity	Hollow
Health · speed · cores	60 · 1.0 m/s · 10 each
Key mechanic	While alive, **sound signatures within 15 m are muted**

Behaviour: clings to reeds; never moves unless attacked. A natural stealth zone. **Look:** grey-green with wing veins that glow faintly; the muted area shows a soft desaturation. **Blighted — Murmur Cicada:** a constant whisper that hides Blightborn sound.

#38 Marrow Mantis

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	III · Predator, ambush, solo
Habitat · maps	Bone Flats · The Elder Ribs
Affinity	Bonespire
Size	3.2 m tall when raised; bone-coloured
Health · damage	2,400 · **150, always a weak-point hit (225)**
Cores · SAP · respawn	160 + 20 SAP · 180 s
Weak point	The narrow neck, front 120°
Key mechanic	Strikes from stealth at **6 m**; cooldown 8 s

Behaviour: stands motionless among fossil bones (a world tell: its forelegs are the only bones folded at that angle). Strikes the closest player's weak point. **Counter-play:** turn your weak point away from bone fields; Bulwark (front) doesn't help a Titan, whose weak point is on its back. **Animation set:** freeze-camouflage, strike, raise threat pose, stalk, death. **Audio:** a dry click just before the strike. **Blighted — Glass Mantis:** leaves Glaze on the weak point it hits.

#39 Sapback Aphids

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Passive herd of 6
Habitat · maps	Rootwilds · Breathing Canopy
Affinity	Verdant
Health · speed · cores	100 each · 1.5 m/s · 10 each
Key mechanic	While **3+ live** on your node: **+2 SAP/s** to your team

Behaviour: feeds on a node; follows a Verdant within 15 m at a distance. **Counter-play:** worth more alive. Protect yours; kill the enemy's. **Blighted — Shard Aphids (Spec):** +2 SAP/s to the Blightborn; 70 Health each.

#40 Hive Colossus (Apex)

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	IV · Apex, solo
Habitat · maps	Ashen Steppe · The Ash Sea (crosses the dunes in Phase 3)
Affinity	Brawler
Size	**14 m tall**, 20 m long; a walking termite-mound creature on six stubby legs
Health	26,000 + **4 shell plates of 2,500**
Attacks	**Slam 300**; releases a **6-wasp swarm every 15 s**
Cores · SAP	400 + 100 SAP (+100 cores per plate broken)
Key mechanic	Body takes **−70% damage** until all four plates are broken

Behaviour: walks a fixed path across the map. Plates (two on each side) are the first targets; each broken plate drops 100 cores on the spot. Slams (1.2 s, ring r 6 m) anything beside its legs. **Counter-play:** split the team across both sides to break plates; area damage for the wasps. **Audio:** a deep internal hum of millions of insects; plates crack like baked clay. **Blighted — Hive of Glass:** releases Glassthread swarms.

#42 Clashhorn Beetles

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	II · Territorial pair
Habitat · maps	Ashen Steppe · Ashfall Crossing (Built: one pair per side at (±30, 12))
Affinity	Brawler
Size	1.4 m tall, 2.2 m long each; long forked horns
Health · damage · speed	900 each · 55 · 4.5 m/s
Cores · respawn	50 each · 90 s
Key mechanic	Ignore everything while dueling. Interrupting makes both attack. **Beating both within 10 s: Momentum 30 s**

Animation set: duel loop (horns locked, shoving), break-off, charge, toss, death. **Audio:** horn clacks every 2 s, audible at 30 m. **Blighted — Glasshorn Beetles:** they never fight each other; they're one mind.

#43 Lumen Bees

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Passive swarm of 6 (Season 4)
Health · speed · cores	80 each · 5.0 m/s (flies) · 18 per swarm
Key mechanic	A node they visit gives **+25% SAP for 60 s**

Behaviour: visits nodes and Hubs in a loop; a visited node glows gold for 60 s. **Blighted form (Proposal) — Glow Bees:** visited Blightborn nodes give the bonus; Wildborn nodes they visit lose 10% SAP for 60 s.

#54 Amber Beetles

Field	Value
Tier · temperament	I · Passive, 5–10
Habitat · maps	Heartwood groves; Breathing Canopy
Affinity	Verdant
Health · speed	100 · 1.5 m/s
Cores · SAP	**0 cores, 15 SAP** each (Verdant: 20 SAP)

Look: a single glowing bead of amber SAP on the back. **Blighted — Glow Beetles (Spec):** 15 SAP to the Blightborn only.

Part 6 — Variants, Invaders and Bosses

Regional variants, the full Blighted set, infection and rallying, sea creatures, the Clamor (Season 3) and the six Hushed Answers. Labels as in Part 1.

6.1 Regional variants (Spec numbers)

Same as the base creature, plus one twist. Art reuses the base rig with a new material set and one silhouette change, so each costs about 30% of a new creature.

Variant	Base	Region · maps	Twist	Art change
Frostfang	Ashfang	Rimewastes · The Sleeper	Bites slow 25% for 2 s	White winter coat; frost on the muzzle; breath visible
Snowback Grazer	Mossback Grazer	Rimewastes · The Sleeper	Grazed cells: capture channels +25% longer	Snow instead of moss on the back; icicles on the horns
Rime Weaver	Weavemother	Rimewastes · The Sleeper, Frozen Falls	Webs break on any hit ≥ 150; anyone caught inside is rooted 1.0 s	Webs of ice lace that glint blue
Cinderfang	Ashfang	Cinderveil · Fevermouth, Glass Forest	Pawprints burn: 15/s for 3 s	Black fur with ember-orange cracks; glowing prints
Magma Beetle	Siege Beetle	Cinderveil · Fevermouth	Lava trail: 30/s for 4 s, structures included	Shell cracked with lava light; drips
Ashwing Moths	Ember Moth	Cinderveil · Fevermouth	Ignite Embergrass on touch (fire spreads 1 m/s for 10 s)	Larger, darker wings with burning edges
Tide Scuttler	Mire Scuttler	Shattered Coast · Shard Reef	Heals 5% max Health/s in surf	Barnacles; sea-green shell
Glow Lizard	Lantern Lizard	Underroot deep caves · The Nerve	Reveal radius 14 m	Larger throat sac; white-amber light

6.2 Blighted forms

Every native except the Heartwood Elk has a Blighted form: the same body and rig, remade in black glass and cyan light. Blighted creatures appear in three ways:

How	Rule (Spec)
Infect (Blightborn player)	3 s channel, range 3 m, on a Tier I–III creature below 50% Health. It fights for the Blightborn for 90 s at 60% Health and +15% damage, follows within 25 m, then dies and its cores go to the infector. One per player
Territory	A neutral creature standing on Blight for 30 s turns hostile to Wildborn only, until it leaves
Native	Glasswaste-adjacent maps and Murmur Surge events spawn Blighted forms directly

Rally is the Wildborn mirror: the same channel and limits; the creature becomes **Kin** (moss-flecked, amber-eyed) and fights for the Wildborn for 90 s, then leaves healed and its cores go to the rallier. **Never converted:** Heartwood Elk, Old Ones, Clamor creatures, Tier IV Apex (except the event-spawned Starbacked and Blighted Wyrm), Hushed Answers.

Converted creature visuals (Proposal)

Look	Infected	Rallied (Kin)
Transition	Glass creeps up from the feet over the 3 s channel	Moss and small flowers spread from the feet over the 3 s channel
Outline	The converter's team colour	Same
Eyes	Violet	Amber
End	Shatters to dust	Shakes itself, the moss falls away, and it walks off

Full Blighted list

Twists marked Spec come from `spec/04`; the rest from `gdd/09` and `gdd/34`. Rows marked **new** are Proposals added here to complete the set.

#	Native	Blighted form	Twist
1	Mossback Grazer	Glassback Grazer	Grazing adds Blight progress 5%/s on neutral or Wildborn cells (Spec)
2	Ashfang	Shardfang	When one is hit, the whole pack aggroes (Spec)
3	Stonehide Ox	Obsidian Ox	Charge leaves Glaze: −20% speed for Wildborn, 10 s (Spec)

#	Native	Blighted form	Twist
4	Glimmerfox	Glintfox	Reveal shows Wildborn only (Spec)
5	Marrowhound	Murmurhound	Delivers eaten cores to the nearest Blightborn within 60 m at 8 m/s (Spec)
6	Duskmane	Hushmane	Cloaks in whispers instead of fog
7	Burrowtusk	Glassdigger	Tunnels lined with Blight
8	Greyback Colossus	The Starbacked	Back node starts blighted (Spec)
9	Strays	Hushed Strays	Evolve after 180 s (Spec)
10	Strider Crane	Shard Crane	Alarm is a ringing chime
11	Rootwalker	Lattice Walker	Guards Blightborn nodes
12	Knucklebrute	Geode Brute	Weak point moves to its back (Spec)
13	Hollowmonk	Whisper Monk	Pauses Wildborn progress only (Spec)
14	Spurlark	Glass Lark	Glittering trails reveal its path
15	Bonewright	Glasswright	Crystal totems buff Blighted creatures
16	The Old Tall	The Tall Hush	Raises Tension only on Wildborn borders
17	Sixhorn Ram	Shardhorn Ram	Longer knockback
18	Trundleback	Geode Shell	Underside visible from 15 m (Spec)
19	Lantern Lizard	Coldlight Lizard	Reveals Wildborn only (Spec)
20	Gravel Skink	Glass Skink	Burrows into Blight, leaving a trail
21	Hexmaw	Glassmaw	Hides under Glaze
22	Sapdrinker	Glowdrinker	Drains Wildborn SAP and adds it to the Blightborn (Spec)
23	Rimeback Stag	Glassback Stag	Stampede leaves Glaze
24	Sixfold Wyrm	Blighted Wyrm	Patron-event version, hunts Wildborn 45 s (Spec)
25	Weavemother	Glass Weaver	Webs can't be burned; shattered by 600 damage (Spec)
26	Threadlings	Glassthreads	60 Health each; visible from 30 m (Spec)
27	Stiltwalker	Shardstilt	Hides Blightborn (Spec)
28	Mire Scuttler	Shard Scuttler	Weak-point hit breaks a claw: front reduction −45% (Spec)
29	Glasslegs	Truly Glass	Silent (Spec)
30	Tendril Crawler	Lattice Crawler	Grabbed players −10% healing for 8 s (Spec)
31	Bone Harvestman	Shard Harvestman	Nest holds Starshards: 100 cores (Spec)
32	Eightfold Matron	Glass Matron	Spawns Glassthreads
33	Ember Moth	Glimmer Moth	Drawn to Blightborn transformations
34	Siege Beetle	Shard Beetle	Damages Wildborn structures only
35	Rootworm	Shardworm	Emerges from fresh Blight
36	Thornwasp	Glasswasp	Chases Wildborn only
37	Hush Cicada	Murmur Cicada	Whisper hides Blightborn sound
38	Marrow Mantis	Glass Mantis	Leaves Glaze on the weak point it hits
39	Sapback Aphids	Shard Aphids	+2 SAP/s to the Blightborn; 70 Health (Spec)
40	Hive Colossus	Hive of Glass	Releases Glassthreads
41	Cairnshell	Geode Hermit	Wears a meteor shard
42	Clashhorn Beetles	Glasshorn Beetles	One mind; never fight each other
43	Lumen Bees	Glow Bees (**new**)	Boosts Blightborn nodes; drains 10% SAP from Wildborn nodes they visit
44	Seedcaller	Shardcaller (**new**)	Cells it crosses become neutral and can't be rooted for 30 s
45	Mossback Calves	Glass Calves (**new**)	Harming one makes a Glassback herd territorial toward Wildborn
46	Emberbark	Glassbark (**new**)	Attacks Clamor creatures and Wildborn
47	Drift Owlbear	Glass-furred Owlbear	Drift is Glaze; wakes only for Wildborn
48	Hoarfrost Mites	Shard Mites	Patches whisper; Blightborn don't slip
49	Cinder Salamander	Obsidian Salamander	Glass stepping stone, Blightborn only
50	Ash Vulture	Glass Vulture	Circles only above Wildborn about to die
51	Tidal Strider	Shard Strider	Hides Blightborn (Spec)
52	Shard Gull	Hush Gull	Silent; larger shards
53	Heartwood Elk	**None**	The Murmur can't touch it
54	Amber Beetles	Glow Beetles	15 SAP to the Blightborn only (Spec)

Material recipe for any Blighted form (Proposal): replace fur, bark and hide with black glass (`#141821`, roughness 0.08) in the same shapes; keep 20–30% of the original organic material showing at joints so the original creature is recognisable; cyan-violet veins run toward the weak point; the eyes become violet. Movement is identical, but groups of Blighted creatures move in sync (§1.9).

6.3 Sea creatures (coastal maps)

Creature	Tier	Health	Role (Spec)	Look and sound (Proposal)
Shoal-lights	Ambient	—	Scatter from shore within 20 m of a fight	Thousands of tiny glowing fish; their scatter is a fight tell at night
Tidecrawlers	I	150	15 cores; groups of 3–5 on beaches	Palm-sized crabs; clicks
Stillsong Whales	Ambient	—	Song (Planet Pulse, coastal): Blight stops spreading within 60 m for 20 s	Only backs and spouts visible far out; low song through the rock
The Deepmaw	Ambient	—	Never fought	A shadow under the reef at night; rises to swallow meteor fragments in a Memory

6.4 The Clamor (Season 3 onward)

A third force that attacks **both** teams. Shared rules (Spec): Clamor creatures **can't be rallied or infected**, attack both teams, and are drawn to the **loudest sound signature within 40 m**. Art: crude, lumpy, asymmetrical; coal glow in cracks; steam; rust-red and ash-black only; frantic movement.

Landfall timeline (Proposal on `gdd/37`)

Time	Event
−30 s	Red streak in the sky beside the Fall-line; low distant roar; the HUD marks the impact flank
−15 s	Wildlife on that flank stampedes toward the other side
−5 s	Sky on the impact flank turns red
0 s	Impact: knockback within 20 m; a smoking crater with the burning **Landfall core** (Proposal: 6,000 Health)
+5 s	Spotting spreads across roots and Blight alike
+15 s	Shriekers pour out
+30 s	Spotting hardens into Crust (cells turn neutral and uncapturable); Spore Kites rise
+60 s	A Roar-vent bursts through if the core still stands; Ventborn defend it
Core destroyed	Scald stops spreading and burns out to grey ash over 60 s

Clamor stat blocks (Spec numbers)

Creature	Tier	Health	Damage	Speed	Group	Cores	Key numbers
Shriekers	I	100 each	10	9.0	Swarm of 6	30 per swarm	While any live: **all players within 20 m are revealed**
Spore Kites	I	120	—	6.0 (flies)	2–4	15 each	Land after 8 s aloft: a **Scald patch**, r 6 m (node goes neutral, uncapturable for 60 s)
Ashmouths	II	900	60	5.0	1–3	60	Eats a body in 3 s: **+10% Health and damage** per body (max 5)
Kindlers	II	700	45	6.5	1–2	50	Sets wildlife within 6 m burning: it panics and stampedes 6 s (20/s burn)
Scald Hulks	III	3,800	130	3.0	Solo	180 + 20 SAP	40% damage reduction; burning trail 20/s for 5 s
Ventborn	III	3,000	150	4.5	2 per vent	160 + 20 SAP	Leash 15 m to its Roar-vent; respawn only while the vent stands

Creature	Size (Proposal)	Look	Sound	Telegraphs
Shriekers	0.6 m, six-legged	Eyeless, all mouth	Constant screaming	None needed (Tier I); their scream radius is shown as a red pulse ring
Spore Kites	2 m wingspan	Flat membranous insects riding heat	A papery flutter	A spore cloud trails them; the landing spot shows a rust decal 2 s before they land
Ashmouths	2.4 m, two-legged	Gaunt; jaws that open far too wide	Wet chewing, shrieks	Feeding is a 3 s kneel (interruptible); each body eaten adds a visible crust lump
Kindlers	1.2 m, eight-legged	Quick, spider-like, glowing abdomens	Crackle and hiss	A 0.4 s abdomen flare before igniting wildlife
Scald Hulks	3.6 m, four-legged	Thick crust, coal-glow cracks	Grinding, hissing steam	Slam 0.7 s with a ring decal; the burning trail is always visible
Ventborn	3.0 m, two-legged	Fully armoured crust; crawl out of vents	A roar in rhythm with the vent	Shield bash 0.6 s, line decal 5 m

The Roar (Clamor apex)

Field	Value
Tier	IV boss
Size	**20 m tall, 45 m long**, four crusted legs; a ridge of six vents along its back

Field	Value
(Proposal)	
Body	Dies when **all vents break**; body takes **−90% damage** (Spec)
Vents	**6 Roar-vents, 6,000 Health each** (Truce: 9,000), weak points (Spec)
Speed	3.0 m/s; each broken vent −10% speed
Stomp	**400, radius 8 m, every 5 s** (Spec); 1.0 s foot-lift telegraph with a ring decal
Chorus	**Cone 90°, 25 m: 250 + silence 1.5 s, every 12 s** (Spec); each broken vent narrows it 15°; 1.2 s wind-up as the vents inhale (they glow brighter), cone decal
Aura	Within 30 m: all sound signatures maxed; calls disabled (Spec)
Ground	Eats roots and Blight: cells it crosses become burned-out neutral for 120 s (Spec)
Reward	800 cores split + 200 SAP per team (Spec)
Where	Clamor Landfall finales; the Truce; Phase 4 Landfalls from Season 6
Counter-play	One player makes noise to pull it while the others break vents; Stillheart slows it (co-op passive)
Animation	Walk, stomp, chorus inhale and blast, vent-break flinch (per vent), collapse into ash
Audio	Every Clamor sound at once; each broken vent removes one voice from the chorus

6.5 The Hushed Answers (bosses)

The Murmur's glass copies of the six First Answers, used in season finales, the Truce and a future Starwound mode. Shared rules (Spec):

Rule	Value
Size	12–20 m tall
Weak points	**3 crystal hearts**; it dies when all three break
Body	**−90% damage**
Heart Health	PvP finale (4 Wildborn): **5,000 each**, phase-scaled · co-op (8 players): **8,000 each**
Targets	Wildborn only (PvP finales) or everyone (co-op)
Phases	Phase 2 after the first heart, Phase 3 after the second: each adds the next attack and −15% to cooldowns
Enrage	6 min after it appears: +50% damage
Reward	First-defeat Memory and cosmetic; 200 cores per player who dealt ≥ 3% of heart damage
Difficulty tiers (co-op)	Hushed (normal) · Ringing (+50% heart Health, faster attacks) · Shattering (+100%, an extra phase, no respawns in the final phase)

Look rules for all six (Proposal): no Kith traces; no team outline; slow, perfect, mechanical movement; a single deep tone per creature; hearts glow cyan through the glass and pulse faster as the fight goes on.

The Glass Range (copy of the Mountain That Walked, Titan) — Season 1 finale

Field	Value
Height	20 m (Proposal)
Speed	2.0 m/s; walks a fixed path
Attack 1 (from start)	**Glass Quake:** radius 10 m, 300, stagger 1.0 s, every 8 s (Spec). Telegraph: 1.0 s, both fists raised, ring decal
Attack 2 (Phase 2)	**Ridge Line:** 40 m line of rising glass, 350, knock-up 1.0 s, every 14 s (Spec). Telegraph: 1.2 s, a crack runs along the line decal
Attack 3 (Phase 3)	**Kneel:** 3 s wind-up, radius 20 m, 600 (Spec). **Stand behind a pillar** (safe zones are the glass pillars raised by Ridge Line)
Hearts	Chest, back, crown (Spec). The back is reachable by flanking; the crown by standing on a Ridge Line pillar
Skill tested	Positioning and flanking
Sound	A struck glass bowl the size of a hill, every step

The Shatterer (copy of the Breaker, Brawler)

Field	Value
Height	14 m, knuckle-walking
Speed	4.0 m/s
Attack 1	**Geode Fists:** 2-hit combo, 250 each, every 4 s (Spec). Telegraph: 0.8 s fist raise per hit
Attack 2 (Phase 2)	**Leap:** lands at the farthest player, radius 6 m, 350, every 15 s (Spec). Telegraph: a 1.0 s crouch; the landing decal appears under the target
Attack 3 (Phase 3)	**Shard Halo:** shards orbit 8 m, 60/s to anyone inside, 10 s (Spec). Telegraph: shards rise around it for 1.0 s
Hearts	Both fists and the spine (Spec). Fist hearts glow for 1 s after each combo
Skill tested	Timing and punishing

The Lattice Grove (copy of the Breath, Verdant)

Field	Value
Form	A walking forest of crystal trees, 12–16 m each
Speed	1.0 m/s
Attack 1	**Glass Roots:** 3 patches r 4 m, root 1.0 s + 150, every 10 s (Spec). Telegraph: glass cracks on the ground 1.0 s ahead
Attack 2 (Phase 2)	**Grow:** blights 2 cells/s around it (Spec). The team must uproot behind it
Attack 3 (Phase 3)	**Chime Heal:** heals 3% max Health/s for 6 s unless interrupted by 2,000 damage to the singing tree (Spec). The singing tree glows and rings
Hearts	Three trees within its grove (Spec); which three changes after each break
Skill tested	Territory control under pressure

The Unspoken (copy of the Quiet, Hollow)

Field	Value
Form	Invisible; a faint violet outline flickers when it attacks
Speed	5.0 m/s
Attack 1	Invisible; **strikes for 280 from behind, every 6 s** (Spec). Tell: a rising whisper from the direction it approaches
Attack 2 (Phase 2)	**Silence Field:** r 15 m, no abilities 3 s, every 18 s (Spec). Telegraph: all sound fades over 1.0 s
Attack 3 (Phase 3)	**Pull:** draws all players to it, 200, then a 300 pulse 1 s later (Spec). Escape the pulse with Evade
Hearts	Visible only for 2 s after each strike (Spec)
Skill tested	Listening; must ship with on-screen sound indicators for accessibility

The Endless Pursuit (copy of the Hunt That Never Ended, Thornrunner)

Field	Value
Form	A long glittering insect-like runner, 12 m tall, 30 m long
Speed	**9.0 m/s**; circles the map
Attack 1	**Marks one player:** +30% damage to them for 10 s, every 15 s (Spec)
Attack 2 (Phase 2)	**Glass-dust trail:** 40/s for 4 s, −20% sight (Spec)
Attack 3 (Phase 3)	**Run-through:** 3 dashes of 25 m, 300 each (Spec). Telegraph: 0.8 s per dash, line decal
Hearts	Head, thorax, tail (Spec); exposed when Marked by a Thornrunner or stunned
Skill tested	Prediction and interception

The Archive (copy of the Rememberer, Bonespire)

Field	Value
Form	A stationary cathedral of glass bones, 18 m
Speed	1.5 m/s (slow turning)
Attack 1	**Glass Lances:** 3 lances, 50 m, 220 each, every 6 s; ×1.5 on weak points (Spec). Telegraph: 0.8 s, a thin line from each lance to its target
Attack 2 (Phase 2)	**Reliquary:** releases 4 frozen creatures (Tier II stats), every 30 s (Spec)
Attack 3 (Phase 3)	**Remember:** repeats the last 3 player abilities used against it (Spec)
Hearts	Three reliquaries on its back (Spec)
Skill tested	Managing adds while focusing one target

Where each appears

Hushed Answer	Map	Season or mode
The Glass Range	Ashfall Crossing	Season 1 finale
The Shatterer	Shard Reef	Coastal finale or Truce wave boss
The Lattice Grove	Breathing Canopy	Bloom-season event
The Unspoken	The Nerve	Rime-season event
The Endless Pursuit	Any large map	Hunt Weekend special
The Archive	The Elder Ribs	A finale about memory
All six	The Hushed Watch (Starwound floor)	Endgame co-op

Part 7 — Structures

Bases, Enemy Cores, Resource Hubs and nodes. Rules and Health are **Spec** (`spec/05` §7). Dimensions, layouts and state visuals are **Proposal**. The **Built** column shows what the playable build uses today.

7.1 Names on each side

Game term	Wildborn	Blightborn	Count
Base	The Cradle	The Clutch	1 per team
Base Heart	The oldest knot	The oldest knot (glazed)	1 per base
Enemy Core	Heartseed	Shard Heart	3 per team
Resource Hub	Sap Well	Glow Well	5 per map, neutral at start
Node	Root-knot	Whisper-node	~30 per map

Mirror rule: rules, stats, sizes and positions are identical for both sides. Only material and sound change. Hubs regrow in the new owner's material when captured; bases and Enemy Cores are destroyed, never taken.

7.2 Damage rules (Spec)

Rule	Value
Player damage to structures	**50%** with basics and ordinary abilities
Siege Ultimates, Siege Beetle	Listed structure damage is **final** (not halved)
Stage 1	Can't damage Shielded Hubs, Enemy Cores or Base Hearts

Siege check (Spec): four Stage 3 attackers (~260 damage/s each, halved) break a Level 0 Hub's Shield in ~4 s, a Level 10 Hub's Shield in ~6 s, an Enemy Core in ~10 s, and a Base Heart in ~38 s without Ultimates (~25 s with two siege Ultimates).

7.3 The base: the Cradle / the Clutch

Layout (Proposal)

The base is a ring of birth-node knots around a pool. Diameter of the playable base: **36 m**.

Element	Position (relative to the base centre)	Size	Function
Birth-pool	Centre	10 m diameter, 0.6 m deep	Conversion point (kneel at the edge)
Base Heart (oldest knot)	Behind the pool, toward the map edge, 8 m from centre	7 m tall, 6 m wide knot	Win condition target
Respawn knots	8 knots on a ring of radius 14 m	2.5 m each	One per player slot; players bud here
Base radius (Built)	—	Conversion works anywhere within the base radius	Built: convert anywhere inside the base radius
Entrances	3 openings in the knot ring (front, two flanks)	Each ≥ 8 m wide	Defensible but never single-file
Edge nodes	2–3 nodes touching the base	—	Become Vulnerable in Phase 4 (Spec)

Base Heart (Spec)

Rule	Value
Health	**20,000** (Built: 12,000, a playtest override, see `game/KNOWN_ISSUES.md` #11)
Attackable	Phase 4, or earlier if all three of that team's Enemy Cores are down at the same time
Damage taken	Only Stage 2+ damage counts
Regeneration	1% max Health/s after 15 s without damage
Destroyed	Instant win

Base visuals

State	Cradle	Clutch
Phase 1	Freshly split knots, glistening; fireflies and Lumen Bees	Knots glazed in glass; cyan light pulsing inside; constant whisper
Phase 2	The pool brightens with every conversion	Same, cyan
Phase 3	Roots spread outward from the ring	Crystal spreads outward
Phase 4	Edge nodes open; the Base Heart's bark splits to show its amber core	Its glass cracks to show the cyan core
Under attack	The Heart's pulse quickens; roots tremble	The hum rises in pitch
Destroyed	The knot splits, the pool drains, the brood's lights go out	The geode shatters; the pool goes dark

Conversion sequence (Spec timings)

Step	Visual	Time
Arrive	Carry aura still humming	—
Kneel	Channel starts	C1 15 s · C2 12 s · C3 9 s (by Hubs held); +1 tier per Enemy Core lost (min 18 s)
Pour	Cores flow out as streams of light into the pool	During the channel
Grow	The pool's light climbs the body; a flash per level gained	End of channel
Stage change	Transformation plays at the pool	If reached
Interrupted	Streams snap back into the body; cores kept, time lost	On damage

Built: the base radius allows conversion anywhere inside the base, and bots convert anywhere inside it (a fix for bots cancelling conversion).

7.4 Enemy Cores: Heartseeds / Shard Hearts

Rule	Value (Spec)
Count	3 per team, in that team's half
Health	**5,000** (regrown: 2,500)
Attackable	From Phase 2
Reward	**300 cores**, split equally among attackers within 20 m (regrown Core: 150)
Denial	−15% victim passive income per Core lost; conversion one C-tier slower per Core lost (min 18 s)
Regrowth	4 min after destruction, 30 s growth, only if the team holds a node adjacent to the site
Built	Enemy Core reward **900** (playtest override)

Dimensions and placement (Proposal)

Element	Value
Heartseed	A 5 m seed half-buried, husk split to show a beating heart; 4 m hitbox radius
Shard Heart	A house-sized geode, 5 m tall; same hitbox
Clear ring	No obstacles within 10 m (so attackers and defenders can both stand around it)
Distance from own base	25–70 m
Adjacent nodes	Each site touches at least 2 nodes, so regrowth can be fought over
Sightline rule	Visible from at least one Hub of its own team

State	Heartseed	Shard Heart	Sound
Young (Phase 1)	A seedling	A crystal bud	Faint pulse
Grown	A full seed, heartbeat visible	A full geode, humming	Muffled pulse / humming
Under attack	The pulse quickens; husk cracks spread	Hum rises in pitch; cracks spread	Audible to the owning team map-wide (quiet)
Destroyed	The husk splits; the heart dims to grey; roots toward the Cradle wither one after another	Shatters outward in a ring of dust that drifts for a minute	A dry crack and a long exhale / a shatter, then silence
Regrowing	A shoot through the husk, 30 s	Needles fuse into a small geode, 30 s	—
Blocked	A withered husk	A pile of glass dust	—

7.5 Resource Hubs: Sap Wells / Glow Wells

Rule	Value (Spec)
Base Health	**6,000**
Defense Levels	0 (bare, on capture) to 10; cost 100 × next level SAP
Per level	+400 Health; +5% damage reduction for **allies inside** (radius 12 m), max 75% total
Level 10 Health	10,000
Shielded (100–66%)	Only Stage 2+ damage counts; can't be uprooted
Exposed (66–33%)	Cells can be uprooted
Collapsing (< 33%)	Uproot at half time; defenders warned
Health floor	Can't go below 1; falls only when **all 6 cells** are uprooted
Regeneration	2% max Health/s after 10 s without damage
On capture	New team's at Level 0, full base Health; old levels lost
Field conversion	70% efficiency, no aggression bonus
Holding	+15% SAP and +10% TI weight each
Neutral at start	All five; captured like a large node (one 4 s channel, then spread)
Built	Hub Defense bought automatically by the team AI

Dimensions (Proposal)

Element	Value
Hub footprint	6 cells (Built: the 6 nearest cells to the Hub centre)
Pool	8 m diameter, centred on the Hub point
Defense ring	Radius 12 m (matches the damage-reduction radius), with 3 openings each ≥ 8 m wide
Capture point	The pool's edge (2 m from the rim)
High ground	Each Hub has one nearby rise or rock from which its dome can be seen across the map

Defense levels in the world (Spec visuals, `gdd/33`)

Level	Sap Well	Glow Well	Height of the ring (Proposal)
0	Bare pool	Bare pool	—
1	Low ring of roots	Short crystal stubs	0.5 m
2–3	Knee-high root walls	Waist-high pillars	1.0–1.5 m
4–5	Shoulder-high walls, moss	Shoulder-high pillars, glowing	2.5–3 m
6–7	Walls arch over parts of the pool; flowers	Pillars lean inward into partial arches	5–6 m
8–9	Near-complete dome of living wood	Near-complete crystal cage	8–10 m
10	Full living dome, one opening, humming	Full crystal cage, ringing softly	12 m

Openings: at every level the ring keeps three openings at least 8 m wide and 10.5 m tall (doorway rule, §1.2). At Level 10 the "single opening" is the visual roof opening; the ground openings remain.

Attack-stage silhouettes

Stage	Visual	Sound
Shielded	Walls or pillars whole	Steady
Exposed	Cracks; roots or lattice show underneath	Groaning / cracking glass
Collapsing	The pool drains in a spiral; its glow flickers	A falling tone; defenders get a HUD warning
Captured	Pool drains and refills in the new material over 3 s	Roots groaning as they thicken / crystal singing as it grows

Scars: a Hub that changes hands keeps traces of its previous owner (half-overgrown crystal, glazed root tips), so by the end of a long match every Well shows its history.

7.6 Nodes and cells

Rule	Value (Spec unless noted)
Nodes per map	About 30, each 1–6 cells
Cells per map	About 110 (Built: a 20 × 12 grid, 240 cells of 14 × 15 m)

Rule	Value (Spec unless noted)
Capture	4 s channel within 2 m of the node core (Verdant 2 s); −1% time per 2 Control, max −50%; interrupted by damage
Uproot	Per cell 5 / 4 / 3 s by the attacker's highest Synergy tier present
SAP	1 SAP/s per cell (Built: 0.1 per cell, playtest override)
Spread	Rooted territory spreads into adjacent neutral cells, ~1 cell per 20 s per border node
States	**Captured** · **Vulnerable** (neutral, or enemy-held and connected to your territory) · **Inaccessible** (not connected, or phase-locked)

Node visuals (Proposal on `gdd/33`)

State	Root-knot / Whisper-node	Height
Neutral	Grey roots breaking the surface, pulsing faintly	1.2 m knot
Captured (Wildborn)	Green shoots and moss spread from the knot	1.8 m
Captured (Blightborn)	Glass from the centre outward; a whisper crystal rises	2.2 m crystal
Vulnerable	Flickers; roots or crystals tremble (every 1.5 s)	—
Inaccessible	Dim and still	—
Being captured	Roots (or Glaze lines) race outward from the channeller to the knot	—
Cells	Ground material changes per cell: matte roots or glossy Glaze (§1.6)	—

Built: a live territory overlay on the terrain shader; a slope mask keeps territory veins off cliffs.

UI rule: minimap and HUD show ownership in **team colours** (gold / red), never side colours, so a Blightborn player never confuses their own cyan with an enemy.

7.7 Structure checklist for a new map

1. Two bases in mirrored positions.
2. Five Hubs: two near each base and one central, equidistant in total from both bases.
3. Three Enemy Core sites per team, each touching at least two nodes.
4. Every Hub's dome visible from at least one high point.
5. No structure placed where a hazard (lava, tide, ice) could destroy it without player action.
6. Return trip to base ≤ 20 s from any Hub on foot at Speed 100% (≤ 100 m of path).

Part 8 — Map Rules and Ashfall Crossing

8.1 Rules every 4v4 map follows

Rule	Value	Source
Playable size	About 320 × 320 m	Spec (`gdd/16`)
Nodes	About 30, ~110 cells (1–6 cells per node)	Spec
Resource Hubs	5: two near each base, one central	Spec
Enemy Core sites	3 per team, in its own half	Spec
Bases	1 per team, a birth-node cluster	Spec
Symmetry	Neither base may have better routes, distances or resources	Spec
Crater zone and Heartwood grove	On the two flanks, each equidistant from both bases	Spec
Memory sites	2–3 per map	Spec
Return trip	≤ 20 s from any Hub to base	Spec
Tension regions	5 per map, one per Hub	Spec (`spec/05` §8)

Symmetry: mirror, not rotation

`gdd/16` asks for rotational symmetry. On a map whose crater zone is on one flank and whose grove is on the other, a 180° rotation would carry the crater onto the grove's side, so the two zones could not both be equidistant from both bases. **Proposal:** use **mirror symmetry across the centre line between the bases** (x = 0 for an east–west map). The flank zones sit on that line, so each is exactly equidistant from both bases. The playable build already does this (Built: `game/src/sim/map.ts`). Maps without flank zones on the centre line (The Skull Basin) may use rotation.

Metrics for greybox (Proposal)

Metric	Value	Why
Base speed	5.0 m/s; sprint 6.5 m/s out of combat after 4 s	Spec
Base → nearest own Hub	50–70 m path (10–14 s)	Early Hub fights near home
Base → central Hub	≤ 130 m path (≤ 20 s at sprint)	Return rule; the central Hub also allows field conversion
Base → own Enemy Cores	25–70 m	Defensible in time
Base → enemy base	240–280 m path	~45–55 s at sprint, so a push is a commitment
Max open sightline at ground level	120 m	Longer than Spire Lance (50 m) but short enough that cover matters
Cover spacing on open ground	A Stage 2-hiding object (≥ 4 m tall) every 25–35 m	Room to move between fights
Chokepoints	≥ 8 m wide; ≤ 2 per route between bases	No single-file traps
Elevation	3 layers: low ground, rises (2–6 m), high points (8–15 m)	Every lineage has a place
Ramps	≤ 30° slope for walking; steeper is a cliff	Built: slope mask stops territory veins on cliffs
Fall damage	None; dropping a level costs time only	`gdd/42` vertical rules

Every map document includes

1. Identity and the fight style it rewards.
2. A layout with coordinates for bases, Hubs, Cores, nodes, flank zones and routes.
3. The signature mechanic with exact timings and telegraphs.
4. Wildlife camps with positions and respawn.
5. Apex spawn and route.
6. Memory sites and callout names.
7. Weather pool, time-of-day moods and lighting.
8. Audio zones.
9. Lineages it favours, and a balance check.
10. A greybox checklist.

8.2 Ashfall Crossing (launch map 1)

Regions: Ashen Steppe above, Underroot below. **Identity:** open teamfights across grassland, flanks through tunnels, and the Grey Migration splitting the map in two. **Favours:** Bonespire (long sightlines), Thornrunner (tunnel flanks), the Commit pair (open teamfights). **Teaches:** timing (the Migration), open fights, the tunnels.

Status

Version	Size	What exists
Built (vertical slice)	280 × 180 m (x −140…140, z −90…90)	Heightfield, 240-cell grid (20 × 12 cells of 14 × 15 m), Voronoi nodes, 5 Hubs, 6 Enemy Cores, 20 wildlife camps, Shardfall Hollow crater, Old Root Knot hill, mirror symmetry
Production (Proposal)	320 × 240 m	The same layout, with the flank zones pushed out to become real places (below) and the Migration road and tunnels added

The coordinates below are the **Built** layout (they are the greybox reference). The production version keeps every x position and scales z by 1.33 for the flanks only (|z| > 50), so the core fighting space stays as tested.

Layout overview

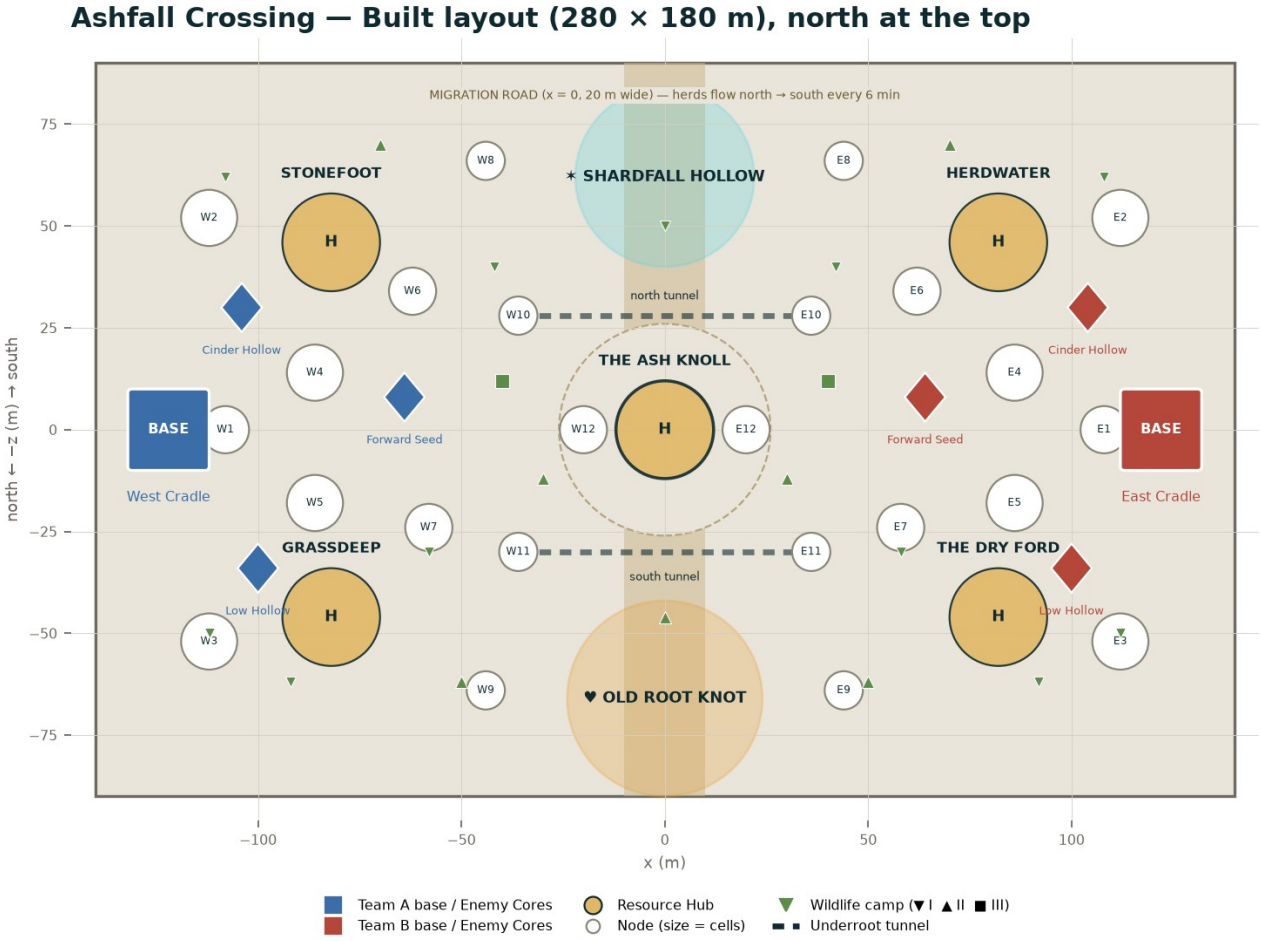


Diagram generated by `design-bible/tools/draw_maps.py` from the coordinates in this part.

Bases, Hubs and Enemy Cores (Built coordinates)

Structure	West team	East team (mirror)	Callout name
Base	(−122, 0)	(122, 0)	West Cradle / East Cradle (the Clutch when Blightborn)
North Hub	(−82, −46)	(82, −46)	**Stonefoot** (W), **Herdwater** (E)
South Hub	(−82, 46)	(82, 46)	**Grassdeep** (W), **The Dry Ford** (E)
Central Hub	(0, 0), shared	—	**The Ash Knoll**
Enemy Core, north	(−104, −30)	(104, −30)	**Cinder Hollow**
Enemy Core, south	(−100, 34)	(100, 34)	**Low Hollow**
Enemy Core, forward	(−64, −8)	(64, −8)	**Forward Seed**

`gdd/16` gives the east Hubs their own names (Herdwater by a watering hole, The Dry Ford at a dry river crossing); because the map is mirrored, each east Hub's set dressing mirrors its west twin's layout with a different landmark,

so callouts stay unique.

Distances (Built layout, straight line)

From → to	Distance	Walk (5 m/s)	Sprint (6.5 m/s)
Base → own north or south Hub	61 m	12 s	9 s
Base → The Ash Knoll	122 m	24 s	19 s
Base → Forward Seed	59 m	12 s	9 s
Base → Cinder Hollow / Low Hollow	35 m / 40 m	7–8 s	6 s
Own north Hub → enemy north Hub	164 m	33 s	25 s
Ash Knoll → Shardfall Hollow centre	62 m	12 s	10 s
Ash Knoll → Old Root Knot centre	66 m	13 s	10 s
Base → enemy base	244 m	49 s	38 s

All Hubs meet the 20 s return rule at sprint speed. The Ash Knoll is the edge case (19 s), which is intended: it's the riskiest Hub to convert from, so field conversion there matters.

Node list (production layout, Proposal)

The Built map generates nodes automatically (Voronoi from mirrored seeds, Hubs take their 6 nearest cells). For production, the nodes are hand-placed and named. West side listed; each east node mirrors it at (−x, z) with the same name and an E prefix.

Node	Position	Cells	Terrain	Notes
W1 Cradle Gate	(−108, 0)	3	Flat ash in front of the base	Base edge node: Vulnerable in Phase 4
W2 North Stones	(−112, −52)	4	Two Standing Stones	Base edge node; Stones hide a Stage 2
W3 South Grass	(−112, 52)	4	Tall Ashgrass	Base edge node; Glimmerfox camp nearby
W4 Ash Flat	(−86, −14)	4	Open, flat	Links the base to the Forward Seed
W5 Grassdeep Field	(−86, 18)	4	Grass with scattered boulders	Between Grassdeep and the base
W6 Watch Rock	(−62, −34)	3	An 8 m rock with a walkable top	**Bonespire perch**: sightline to the Ash Knoll
W7 Herd Track	(−58, 24)	3	A worn trench (the Herdpath)	Spurlark camp; cover from the trench walls
W8 Ridge Lip	(−44, −66)	2	Rim of Shardfall Hollow	Overlooks the crater
W9 Root Edge	(−44, 64)	2	Roots breaking the surface	Approach to the Old Root Knot
W10 North Tunnel Mouth	(−36, −28)	2	A root-ringed hole	Entrance to the north tunnel
W11 South Tunnel Mouth	(−36, 30)	2	A root-ringed hole	Entrance to the south tunnel
W12 Road Bank	(−20, 0)	3	The west bank of the Migration road	Closest node to the Ash Knoll; flooded by herds during the Migration
Shardfall Hollow	(0, −62)	5	Crater floor with Starshard veins	Flank zone; Blight 2× faster, roots 50% slower
Old Root Knot	(0, 66)	5	Twisted root-hill	Flank zone; roots 2× faster, Blight 50% slower
Hubs (5)	See above	6 each	—	—

Totals: 24 side nodes + 2 flank nodes + 5 Hubs = **31 nodes**; 72 + 10 + 30 = **112 cells**.

Terrain and height (Built)

Feature	Where	Height
Rolling steppe	Everywhere	±3.5 m noise
North and south ridges	z beyond ±70	Rise steeply (up to ~16 m); keep play inside
East and west edges	x beyond ±128	Rise behind the bases
The Ash Knoll	Centre, radius 26 m	+4.5 m
Shardfall Hollow	(0, −62), radius 22 m	−7 m bowl with a +5 m rim
Old Root Knot	(0, 66)	A raised, twisted root-hill

Obstacles (Built): ~140 mirrored boulders (r 1.2–3.8 m) kept 18 m clear of every base, Hub and Core; meteor shards inside the crater (r 1.4 m), roots on the knot. Creature navigation uses a 2 m A* grid; the camera collides with rocks.

The Grey Migration (signature mechanic, Proposal timings on Spec rule)

Rule	Value
Timing	Every **6 min** for **60 s** (`gdd/16`): at 6:00, 12:00, 18:00, 24:00 (Short match: every 3 min for 30 s)
Warning	**20 s** before: a dust wall rises on the north horizon, the ground hums, Ember Moths and Gravel Skinks flee south; the HUD shows a 20 s timer and highlights the road
The road	A band **20 m wide** along x = 0, from the north ridge to the south ridge, except the Ash Knoll itself
During	Herds flow north → south along the road at 7 m/s. Anyone on the road takes **40 damage/s** and is pushed 6 m/s south-east or south-west off the road (Stage 3 Titans: pushed 3 m/s). Ground-targeted abilities can't be placed on the road
The Knoll	The herds split around the Ash Knoll, which becomes an **island**: whoever is on it is cut off for 60 s, reachable only through the **Knoll Shaft** from the tunnels
Crossing	Only through the Underroot tunnels
After	The herds' dust settles; the road shows trampled grass for 30 s (cosmetic); Ash Vultures arrive

Herd composition (cosmetic, not targetable): Mossback-like grazers, Rimeback-like stags and Stiltwalkers, rendered as an instanced crowd of ~150 animals using 6 LOD'd models with vertex animation. They're scenery during the crossing: they can't be attacked and drop nothing, so the Migration never becomes a farm.

Phase 3 onward: the **Greyback Colossus** walks with the herd (it spawns at the north end at the start of a Migration and continues at 2.5 m/s after the herd has passed, so it crosses the map in ~70 s and then turns back north along the same road). Its back is a moving 3-cell node. It's the map's Tier IV.

The Underroot tunnels (Proposal)

Tunnel	From	To	Length	Width × height	Notes
North tunnel	W10 (−36, −28)	E10 (36, −28)	~80 m with bends	7 m × 11 m	Two Lantern Lizards on the walls; one side alcove per half
South tunnel	W11 (−36, 30)	E11 (36, 30)	~80 m	7 m × 11 m	Two Lantern Lizards; a Burrowtusk den in a side chamber
Knoll Chamber	Under the Ash Knoll, joining both tunnels by short passages	—	24 m across	11 m high	Lit by nerve-roots; pulses every 20 s (cosmetic)
Knoll Shaft	Knoll Chamber → top of the Ash Knoll	—	10 m vertical	6 m wide	Climbed on Bonevine at 2.5 m/s; one-way down is a drop (no damage)

Rules: tunnels hold no nodes (territory is a surface system). Sight is 18 m inside. Sound carries ×1.5 (footsteps heard farther). The surface minimap shows tunnels as a dashed overlay and players in them only when revealed.

Flank zones

Shardfall Hollow (north, crater zone). A field of fallen meteor shards in a 22 m bowl. - Blight spreads 2× faster, roots 50% slower (Spec). - **Starshard veins:** 3 veins (500 Health each, Proposal) in the crater floor; breaking one releases **60 cores** in a burst (Proposal; Spec says "large core caches"). They regrow every 4 min. - **Shard storms** (hazard, Proposal): every 4 min from Phase 2, a 20 s storm inside the bowl; 12 damage/s to anyone not under a shard overhang; sight 15 m. Telegraphed 10 s ahead by glittering haze. - Memory site: *The Sky Breaks*, an impact scar at the bowl's lowest point. - Built: 9 mirrored shard obstacles inside the bowl.

Old Root Knot (south, Heartwood grove). A twisted root-hill with SAP springs. - Roots spread 2× faster, Blight 50% slower (Spec). - **SAP springs:** 2 springs (Proposal); standing in one for 3 s gives your team **20 SAP**; each refills in 60 s. - **Grasping ground** (hazard, Proposal): patches of moving roots; anyone standing still on one for 1.5 s is rooted 0.8 s (2 s cooldown per player). Visible as twitching roots. - The Heartwood Elk can appear here (rare).

Wildlife camps (Built)

West camps listed; each has a mirrored twin at (−x, z). Two extra camps sit on the centre line.

Camp	West position	Species	Tier	Notes
1	(−108, −62)	Gravel Skink	I	Behind North Stones
2	(−92, 62)	Gravel Skink	I	Behind South Grass
3	(−58, 30)	Spurlark	I	On the Herd Track
4	(−42, −40)	Glimmerfox	I	Near Watch Rock
5	(−70, −70)	Ashfang pack	II	Below the north ridge
6	(−50, 62)	Mossback Grazer herd	II	Toward the Old Root Knot
7	(−30, 12)	Clashhorn Beetles	II	Near the Road Bank
8	(−112, 50)	Glimmerfox	I	Base flank

Camp	West position	Species	Tier	Notes
9	(−40, −12)	Stonehide Ox	III	Between the Forward Seed and the Knoll
Centre	(0, −50)	Gravel Skink	I	Crater approach
Centre	(0, 46)	Mossback Grazer herd	II	Grove approach

Placement check. The Built camps give Tier I 11 groups · Tier II 7 · Tier III 2, which is **below** the Spec range for a standard map (Tier I 16–20 · II 10–12 · III 4–6).

Production additions (Proposal) to reach the range:

Addition	Per side	Tier
Strays, near W4 and W5	2 groups	I
Ember Moths over the Ashgrass (dusk and night)	1 swarm	I
Lantern Lizards in the tunnels (shared, 4 total)	—	I
Stiltwalker looping the north plain (cover for crossing open ground)	1	II
A second **Ashfang** pack on the south plain, (−66, 70)	1	II
A second **Stonehide Ox**, (−64, 56)	1	III

Totals with additions: Tier I 17 groups · Tier II 11 · Tier III 4 · Tier IV 1 (Greyback Colossus, Phase 3).

Memory sites

Memory	Where	Trigger
The Hunt Passes	A rise on the north ridge, (−20, −80) and mirrored	Stand there at dusk; the Hunt That Never Ended can be glimpsed far off
The Sky Breaks	Shardfall Hollow's lowest point (0, −62)	Touch the impact scar

Horizon landmarks

Direction	What players see
North	The Standing Stones in a line; Shardfall Hollow's glitter; the Fall-line in the sky
West	The Vertebrae, far off
South	Greymother on the southern horizon (rare)
Beside the road	**The Scarred Runner** (Old One) walks beside every Migration, beyond the north ridge

Weather, light and time of day

	Value
Weather pool	Clear, Ashfall, Breathing Night (Spec)
Dawn	Mist over the grass
Day	Pale and open
Dusk	Gold light; long shadows of the Stones; Ember Moths rise
Night	The Fall-line overhead; the Migration's dust glowing
Built lighting	Sky, fog, shadows, environment map; grey-gold haze

Audio zones (Proposal)

Zone	Bed	Spot sounds
Open steppe	Wind through grass, distant herds	Skink rattles, Spurlark trills, Ashfang howls at night
The Ash Knoll	Wind stronger, ash hissing	Hub sound (roots groaning / crystal singing)
Shardfall Hollow	Glass chiming in the wind, a low whisper	Shard storm hiss; vein cracks
Old Root Knot	Creaking roots, a slow heartbeat	SAP spring bubbling
Tunnels	Dripping water, nerve hum	Lantern Lizard ticks; echoing footsteps
Migration	A rising rumble 20 s ahead; then thunder of hooves	Bellows, dust

Greybox checklist

- [x] Bases, Hubs, Cores at mirrored positions (Built)
- [x] Crater and grove on the centre line (Built)
- [x] Wildlife camps mirrored (Built)
- [ ] Migration road (20 m band) with the Knoll island
- [ ] Two tunnels, Knoll Chamber and Knoll Shaft
- [ ] Hand-placed named nodes (replacing Voronoi)
- [ ] Starshard veins, SAP springs, shard storms, grasping ground

- [ ] Watch Rock perches (8 m, walkable tops)
- [ ] Greyback Colossus route and back-node
- [ ] Production flank expansion (z ±120)

Part 9 — The Elder Ribs and Breathing Canopy

Both launch maps follow the rules in §8.1. Identity, mechanics, wildlife, Memory sites, callouts and weather pools are **Spec** (`gdd/16`). Coordinates, node lists, dimensions and timings are **Proposal** for greybox. Neither map is built yet.

9.1 The Elder Ribs (launch map 2)

Region: Bone Flats. **Identity:** siege play around a central fortress made of the Rememberer's fossil ribcage. **Fight style:** siege and defence; chokepoints. **Favours:** Bonespire (rib-top vantage), Titan and Brawler (holding the entrances), anyone good at weak points. **Teaches:** sieges, chokepoints, weak points.

Orientation and symmetry

Bases are **north and south**. The mirror line is **z = 0**, running east–west along the ribcage's spine. The flank zones sit on that line: **Graveroot** (Heartwood grove) at the far west, the **Glass Fossil Field** (crater zone) at the far east.

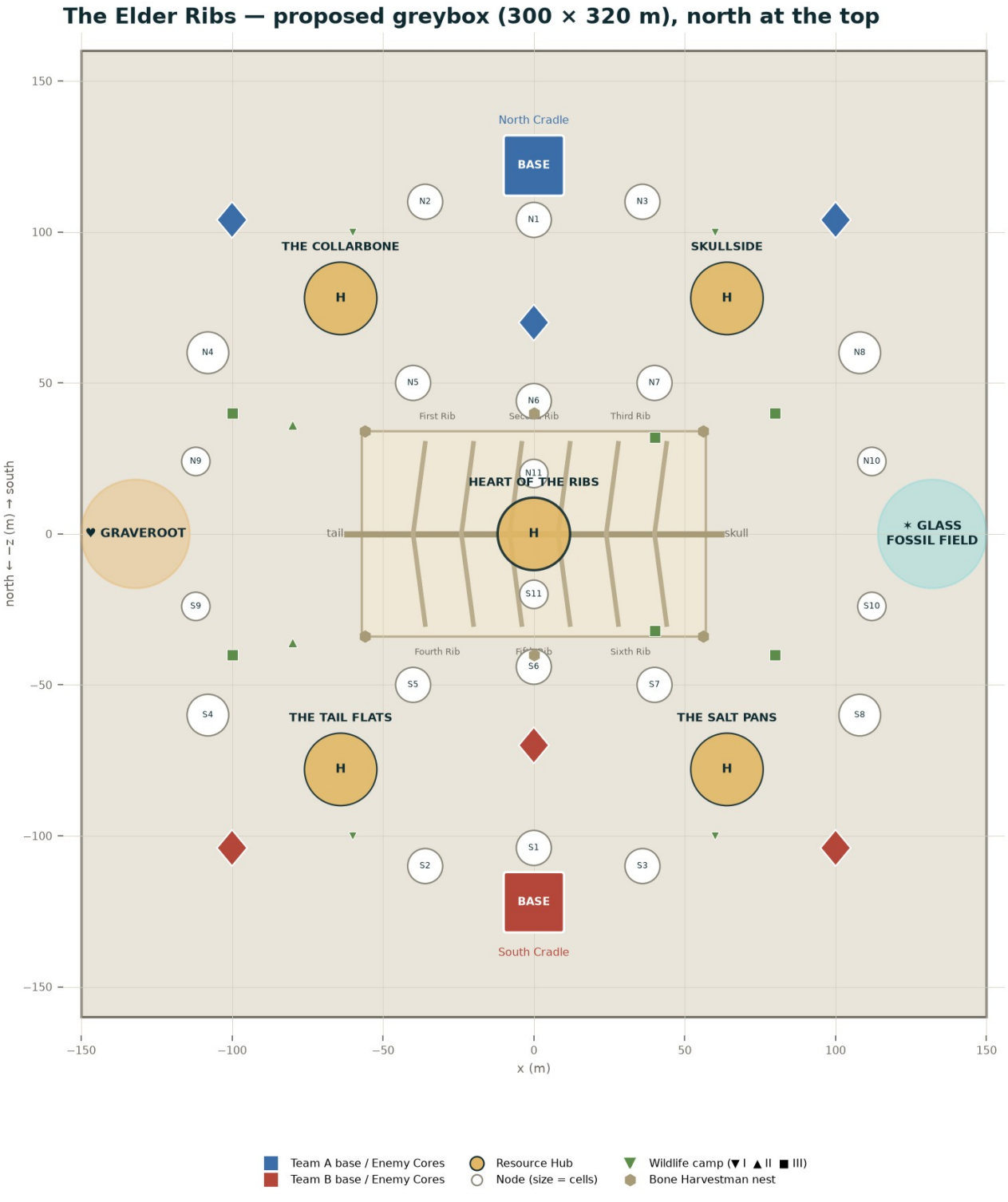


Diagram generated by `design-bible/tools/draw_maps.py` from the coordinates in this part.

Structures

Structure	North team	South team (mirror)	Callout
Base	(0, −122)	(0, 122)	North Cradle / South Cradle
West Hub	(−64, −78)	(−64, 78)	**The Collarbone** (N) · **The Tail Flats** (S)
East Hub	(64, −78)	(64, 78)	**Skullside** (N) · **The Salt Pans** (S)
Central Hub	(0, 0) inside the ribcage	—	**The Heart of the Ribs**
Enemy Core, west	(−100, −104)	(−100, 104)	North-West / South-West Core
Enemy Core, east	(100, −104)	(100, 104)	North-East / South-East Core
Enemy Core, forward	(0, −70)	(0, 70)	Spine Core

Distances: base → own Hubs 78 m (16 s walk, 12 s sprint); base → The Heart of the Ribs 122 m (19 s sprint); base → forward Core 52 m; base → enemy base 244 m.

The ribcage (centrepiece)

Element	Value
Footprint	110 m (east–west, along the spine) × 64 m (north–south)
Spine	A fossil backbone along z = 0, 6 m high, walkable on top from the tail end (west)
Ribs	6 ribs per side arch from the spine to the ground; each 40–60 m long, 4 m thick, peaking 18 m high
Entrances	The gaps between ribs that reach the ground: **3 on the north side, 3 on the south** (First–Third Rib north, Fourth–Sixth Rib south), each **10–14 m wide**, 12 m tall
Floor	Salt-crusted, 80 × 44 m inside; the Hub pool sits in the centre
Rib tops	Reached by **Bonevine** at 4 points (two per side, outside the cage); climbing 2.5 m/s; each rib top is a 3 m-wide walkway
Vantage	Rib tops overlook the whole map; the best Bonespire perch in the launch set. They're exposed from both sides
Skull end (east)	The fossil skull, 25 m tall, half-buried; its eye socket is a cave with the *Not the Titan* Memory
Tail end (west)	Vertebrae trailing into the ground toward Graveroot
Cover inside	Fallen rib fragments (3–5 m tall) in a ring around the Hub, 15 m from the pool

Fight logic. Holding the Heart of the Ribs means holding up to six entrances. A team inside can defend with Titans and Brawlers at the gaps while a Bonespire covers from the rib tops. Attackers split across entrances, or take the rib tops first. Each side's three entrances face its own base, so neither team starts closer to more entrances.

Node list (north side; south mirrors at (x, −z))

Node	Position	Cells	Terrain	Notes
N1 North Gate	(0, −104)	3	Salt flat in front of the base	Base edge node
N2 West Bones	(−36, −110)	3	Bone field (slows 10%)	Base edge node
N3 East Bones	(36, −110)	3	Bone field	Base edge node
N4 Collar Field	(−108, −60)	4	Open salt	Near the Collarbone
N5 First Approach	(−40, −50)	3	Fossil cover	Leads to First Rib
N6 Spine Approach	(0, −44)	3	Open, exposed	Leads to Second Rib; Spine Core nearby
N7 Third Approach	(40, −50)	3	Fossil cover	Leads to Third Rib
N8 Skull Field	(108, −60)	4	Salt pans with Harvestman nests	Near Skullside
N9 Graveroot Edge	(−112, −24)	2	Roots wrapping bones	Grove approach
N10 Glass Edge	(112, −24)	2	Glazed fossils	Crater approach
N11 Rib Top North	On the northern rib tops	2	Bone walkway	A high node: capture from the walkway
Graveroot	(−132, 0)	5	Heartwood grove	Roots ×2, Blight ×0.5; SAP springs; grasping ground
Glass Fossil Field	(132, 0)	5	Crater zone	Blight ×2, roots ×0.5; Starshard veins inside glass fossils
Hubs (5)	—	6 each	—	—

Totals: 22 side nodes + 2 flank + 5 Hubs = **29 nodes**, 64 + 10 + 30 = **104 cells**.

Signature mechanics

Bone nests (Spec rule, Proposal placement). Six Bone Harvestman nests around the outside of the ribcage, three per side, mirrored: (−56, ±34), (0, ±40), (56, ±34). Each fills with 1 core per 3 s up to 80 (4 min). Both teams have a reason to patrol the outside of the Ribs. Harvestman bone-clicking is a constant background sound near the cage.

Salt glare (Proposal). In Clear weather at "noon" (the middle third of the day cycle), looking within 30° of the sun's direction across the salt reduces sight to 22 m and washes out colours; team outlines stay at full strength. Both sides face the sun equally because the sun path runs east–west along the mirror line.

Wildlife (Spec list, Proposal positions; north side, mirrored)

Species	Tier	Positions	Notes
Bone Harvestman	II	3 nests (above)	Core caches
Marrowhound pair	II	(−80, −36)	Scavenge every fight
Bonewright + 3 totems	III	(−100, −40)	Buffs nearby wildlife

Species	Tier	Positions	Notes
Trundleback	III	Loops (−30…30, −30)	Climbable high ground; underside weak point
Siege Beetle	III	(80, −40)	Lure it into enemy Cores
Marrow Mantis	III	Among fossils at (40, −32)	Ambush from bones
Strays	I	2 groups at (±60, −100)	Wild evolution
Gravel Skinks	I	(±24, −90), 2 groups	Early income

Apex: none native (Spec). Patron events wake the **Old Tall** (Planet Pulse) or a **Blighted Wyrm** (Murmur Surge). The Old Tall walks Hub to Hub: Collarbone → Heart → Salt Pans (or mirrored).

Memory sites

Memory	Where
The Rememberer's Vigil	Inside the ribcage, at the base of the spine (−50, 0)
The Hushed	A glass fossil in the Glass Fossil Field, showing the Murmur's first copies
Not the Titan	Inside the skull's eye socket (east end)

Horizon and mood

	Value
Horizon	The Skull Basin's rim; the Cairnback on the western skyline; the Bone-Keeper far out on the flats
Weather pool	Clear (salt glare at noon), Shard Storm, Breathing Night (Spec)
Dawn	Salt glittering
Day	Harsh glare
Dusk	The Ribs glowing orange
Night	Moonlight through the ribs, striped shadows across the floor
Audio	Wind whistling through the ribs (a different note per gap, so a player can tell which entrance they're near by ear)

9.2 Breathing Canopy (launch map 3)

Regions: Rootwilds and Hollow Mire. **Identity:** a tight ambush map where the forest itself changes the sightlines. **Fight style:** ambush and skirmish; many small nodes. **Favours:** Verdant and Hollow (nodes and stealth), Thornrunner (ambush). **Teaches:** territory, stealth, reading the world (cranes, the canopy cycle).

Orientation

Bases **west and east**, mirror line **x = 0**. **The Breathing Valley** (Heartwood grove) is north at (0, −84); **The Fallen Shard** (crater zone) is south, sunk in the mire at (0, 88).

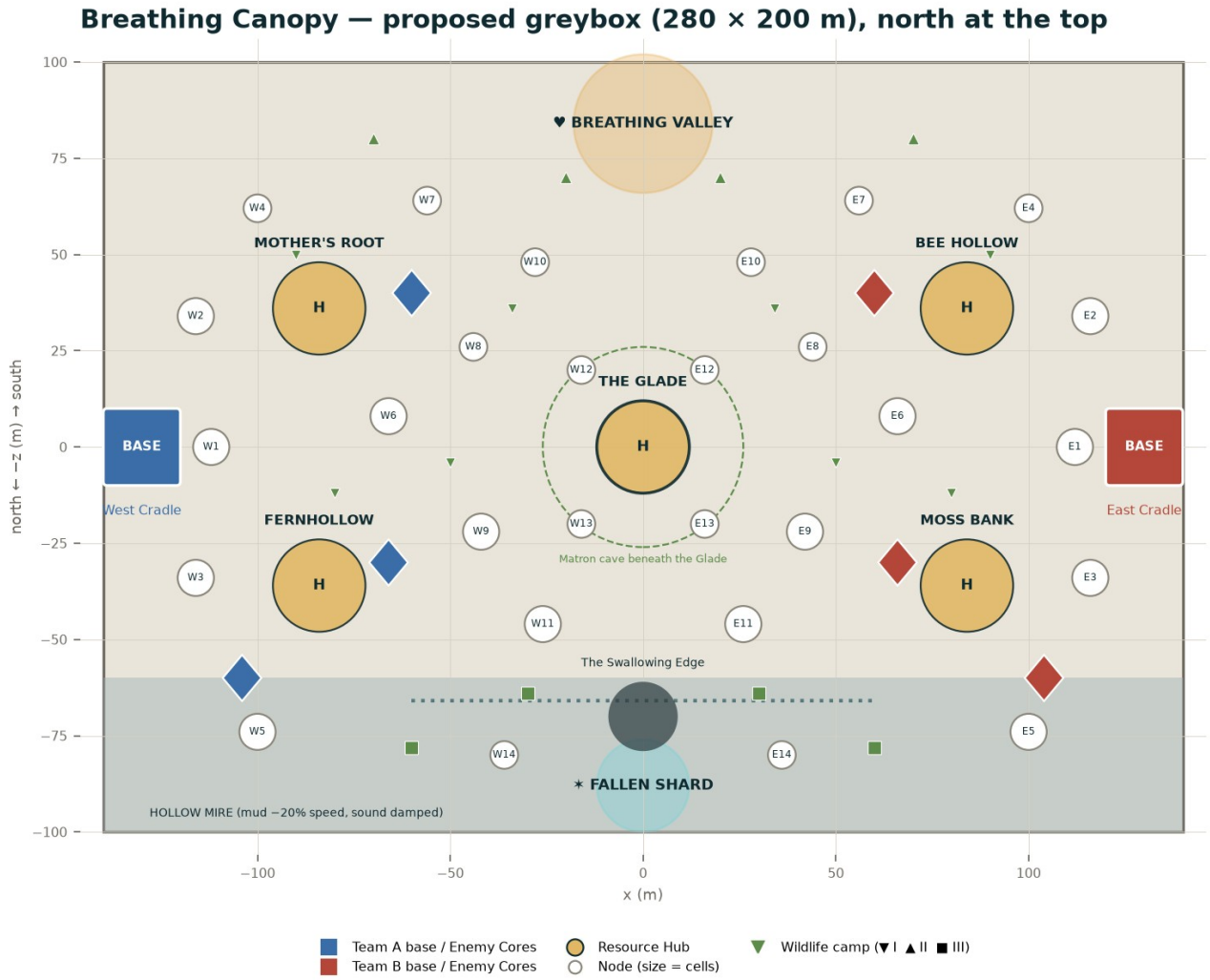


Diagram generated by `design-bible/tools/draw_maps.py` from the coordinates in this part.

Structures

Structure	West team	East team (mirror)	Callout
Base	(−130, 0) at the foot of a great breathing oak	(130, 0)	West / East Cradle
North Hub	(−84, −36)	(84, −36)	**Mother's Root** (W) · **Bee Hollow** (E)
South Hub	(−84, 36)	(84, 36)	**Fernhollow** (W) · **Moss Bank** (E)
Central Hub	(0, 0)	—	**The Glade**
Enemy Core, north	(−60, −40)	(60, −40)	Oak Core
Enemy Core, south	(−66, 30)	(66, 30)	Fern Core
Enemy Core, mire	(−104, 60)	(104, 60)	Mire Core
Mire route	(−60…60, 66)	—	**The Swallowing Edge**

Distances: base → own Hubs 60 m; base → The Glade 130 m (20 s sprint, the limit); base → enemy base 260 m. Paths wind between trunks, so real path lengths are ~15% longer than straight lines; check the Glade return in greybox and move the bases 6 m inward if needed.

The breathing canopy (signature mechanic)

Rule	Value
Cycle	**90 s** (Spec)
Rise	The canopy lifts over 10 s, stays **open for 30 s** (Spec: rises for 30 s), then falls over 10 s
Closed	40 s of dense shade
Open state	Normal sight (30 m; Stage 3 40 m); light floods in; Bonespire ranges usable
Closed state (Proposal)	Sight under the canopy **18 m**; minimap reveals from sight shrink to match; footsteps ×0.8 range
Telegraph	A deep inhale sound 5 s before rising; an exhale and a mist puff 5 s before falling; the HUD shows a breathing ring
Clearings	The Glade and the Hubs are open sky: sight never drops there

Rule	Value
Sync	The whole map breathes together; both teams get the same cycle

Fight logic. Open phases favour ranged pick-offs and rotations; closed phases favour ambushes and stealth captures. Good teams time pushes to the breath.

Node list (west side; east mirrors at (−x, z))

Many small nodes (Spec), so territory changes hands constantly.

Node	Position	Cells	Terrain
W1 Oak Gate	(−112, 0)	2	Roots of the base oak (base edge)
W2 North Ferns	(−116, −34)	2	Fern dell (base edge)
W3 South Ferns	(−116, 34)	2	Fern dell (base edge)
W4 Lantern Trees	(−100, −62)	1	Lanternmoss trees
W5 Mire Bank	(−100, 74)	2	Mire edge (mud −20% speed)
W6 Bramble Run	(−66, −8)	2	Dense undergrowth
W7 Old Log	(−56, −64)	1	A fallen giant trunk (walk along the top)
W8 Deer Path	(−44, −26)	1	Narrow trail
W9 Sap Spring	(−42, 22)	2	A small SAP spring (Sapdrinker nest)
W10 Aphid Bush	(−28, −48)	1	Sapback Aphid herd
W11 Web Hollow	(−26, 46)	2	Weavemother's web (contested node)
W12 Glade Edge North	(−16, −20)	1	Edge of the clearing
W13 Glade Edge South	(−16, 20)	1	Edge of the clearing
W14 Reed Bank	(−36, 80)	1	Whisperreed (Hush Cicadas)
The Breathing Valley	(0, −84)	4	Heartwood grove; Heartbloom grows here
The Fallen Shard	(0, 88)	4	Crater zone in the mire; Glasscap fungus
Hubs (5)	—	6 each	—

Totals: 28 side nodes + 2 flank + 5 Hubs = **35 nodes**, 42 + 8 + 30 = **80 cells**. Fewer cells than the 110 target is intended: smaller nodes flip faster. Verdant capture (2 s) dominates here.

The Hollow Mire (south)

Rule	Value
Mud	−20% speed (Spec)
Sound	Damped: footsteps ×0.6 range in the mire (Proposal)
Hush Cicadas	3 colonies along the Swallowing Edge: sound signatures within 15 m muted
Strider Cranes	2 flocks in the shallows: startling them reveals the startler for 4 s
The Swallowing Pool	Centre of the mire (0, 70). Anyone who dies within 10 m of it: their dropped cores **sink after 10 s** instead of 30 s (Proposal, from `gdd/41`)
Fog	Permanent low fog (1.5 m deep): Base Forms and Stage 1 are partly hidden

The Matron's cave

The **Eightfold Matron** lives in a cave beneath the Glade. Entrances: two ramps, west (−22, 10) and east (22, 10), each 8 m wide, dropping 12 m. The cave is 40 m across with roots hanging from the ceiling. **Her nest wakes in Phase 3** (Spec): a map-wide warning, then she's fightable for 400 split cores and 100 SAP.

Wildlife (Spec list, Proposal positions; west side, mirrored)

Species	Tier	Position
Glimmerfoxes	I	(−90, −50), (−50, 4)
Mossback Grazer herd	II	(−70, −80) toward the Valley
Threadling swarms	I	(−80, 12), (−34, −36)
Rootworms	I	Spawn on freshly rooted nodes
Sapdrinker	II	On W9 Sap Spring
Sapback Aphids	I	On W10 Aphid Bush
Weavemother	III	Over W11 Web Hollow (webs a node every 60 s)
Duskmane	III	The mire, (−60, 78)
Hexmaw	III	Mire edge, (−30, 64)
Strider Cranes	I	The mire shallows
Hollowmonk	II	(−20, −70) near the Valley

Species	Tier	Position
Amber Beetles	I	In the Breathing Valley

Apex: the Eightfold Matron (Phase 3).

Memory sites

Memory	Where
The Breath's Wall	The first tree of the forest-wall, (0, −100) at the back of the Valley
The Quiet Descends	The edge of the Swallowing Pool, (0, 70)

Horizon and mood

	Value
Horizon	The Weaver's Hollow glowing at dawn; Old Hush floating motionless above the mire
Weather pool	Clear, Sap Rain, Rime Fog, Breathing Night (Spec)
Dawn	The canopy exhales mist
Day	Dappled light
Dusk	Moth Bloom rising
Night	Lanternmoss, fireflies, Blight glow
Audio	Birdsong, rustling, the canopy's breath; silence in the mire

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9.3 The three launch maps compared

	Ashfall Crossing	The Elder Ribs	Breathing Canopy
Fight style	Open teamfights	Siege and defence	Ambush and skirmish
Nodes · cells	31 · 112	29 · 104	35 · 80
Node size	Large, fewer	Medium, around the Ribs	Small, many
Signature mechanic	Grey Migration (6 min)	Bone nests and rib entrances	Canopy breathing (90 s)
Native apex	Greyback Colossus	None (patron events)	Eightfold Matron
Lineages favoured	Bonespire, Thornrunner, Commit pair	Bonespire, Titan, Brawler	Verdant, Hollow, Thornrunner
Longest sightline	~120 m across the plain	Rib tops: the whole map	30 m (open) / 18 m (closed)

Part 10 — Post-Launch Maps

Ten maps after launch: four seasonal 4v4 maps, two 2v2 arenas and four later or proposed 4v4 maps. Identities, signature mechanics, wildlife and favoured lineages are **Spec** (`gdd/16`, `gdd/30`, `gdd/42`). Coordinates, node counts and exact timings are **Proposal**. All follow §8.1 unless noted.

#	Map	Region	Mode	Arrives
4	Fevermouth	Cinderveil	4v4	Season 2
5	The Sleeper	Rimewastes	4v4	Season 2
6	Shard Reef	Shattered Coast	4v4	Season 3
7	The Nerve	Underroot	4v4	Season 4
8	The Skull Basin	Bone Flats	2v2	With Brood Skirmish
9	The Ash Sea	Ashen Steppe	4v4	Season 5+
10	The Glass Forest	Cinderveil / Glasswaste	4v4	Season 5+
11	The Weaver's Hollow	Rootwilds	4v4	Proposal
12	The Heron Reach	Hollow Mire	2v2	Proposal
13	The Frozen Falls	Rimewastes	4v4	Proposal

10.1 Fevermouth (Cinderveil)

Identity: fast, dangerous fights around a volcano that reshapes the map on a timer. **Favours:** Brawler and Titan (Embergrass charges), Thornrunner (fast rotations between eruptions).

Layout	Value
Orientation	Bases west and east; mirror x = 0
The Fevermouth	A volcano cone at (0, −30), 60 m tall, crater 40 m across (not walkable)
Central Hub	**The Mouth**, on the lower slope at (0, 10)
Lava channels	**North, Middle, South**: three channels from the crater down to the map edges, each 10–14 m wide, crossing both halves symmetrically (each channel forks at x = 0 into a west and an east branch)
Crater zone	**Ashglass Field**, north flank (0, −100)
Heartwood grove	**Ember Root**, south flank (0, 100)
Bases	Cooled lava basins ringed with Ember Root, at (±130, 20)

Eruption cycle (Spec rule, Proposal detail)

Rule	Value
Interval	Every **4 min** (Short match: 2 min)
Channel choice	One of the three, never the same twice in a row
Warning	The chosen channel **glows and rumbles 20 s ahead** (Spec); the HUD marks it
Lava	Flows down both branches of the channel at 8 m/s; burns **80 damage/s** while standing in it (Proposal); lasts 25 s, then crusts
Cooling rock	Cells the lava crossed become **neutral and uncapturable for 60 s** (Spec), cutting a strip through both teams' territory
Structures	No Hub, Core or base is inside a channel (§7.7)
Cinder Salamanders	Killing one in a channel leaves a stepping stone (45 s; Titan 90 s)

Embergrass: fields that burn when a Titan or Brawler charges through (Rampart Charge, Roll Commit, Avalanche, Wrecking Rush). Fire spreads 1 m/s for 10 s, 20 damage/s; Ashwing Moths also ignite it. **Wildlife:** Cinderfangs, Magma Beetles (lava trails), Ashwing Moths, Cinder Salamanders, Ash Vultures. **Memory:** *The Fever*: the planet waking its volcanoes to burn out the infection. **Callouts:** The Mouth · North / Middle / South Channel · Ashglass Field · Ember Root. **Weather:** Clear, Ashfall. **Horizon:** the Glass Forest's dark edge; the Cairnback in the west. **Risk:** random channel choice can decide a fight; the 20 s warning and the strict rotation (never twice in a row) keep it readable.

10.2 The Sleeper (Rimewastes)

Identity: slow, tense fights on a frozen lake above a giant that might be waking. **Favours:** Hollow and Verdant (dry land and shore nodes), Bonespire (long sightlines across the ice).

Layout	Value
Orientation	Bases west and east on the lake shores, half-buried in snow; mirror x = 0
The lake	An oval 200 × 140 m in the centre; the Sleeper visible deep beneath the ice
Central Hub	**The Eye**, on a rock island in the lake's centre
Shore Hubs	Four, on the lakeshore (two per side)
Crater zone	**Rimeglass**, west flank in `gdd/16`; with mirror symmetry it sits on the centre line, north (0, −110)
Heartwood grove	**The Warm Spring**, south (0, 110): SAP keeps the ice open
Snow Halls	Caves in the north cliffs where Drift Owlbears sleep

Breakable ice (Spec rule, Proposal numbers)

Rule	Value
Ice panels	The lake is divided into hexagonal panels ~12 m across
Crack	A heavy impact cracks a panel: Titan slams, Brawler Roll Commit, any Stage 3 landing, Avalanche, Wrecking Rush
Break	A cracked panel gives way under the next heavy hit, or after 20 s with any Stage 2+ standing on it
In the water	−40% speed and **2% max Health/s** damage until they climb out (Spec) at any panel edge (1.0 s climb)
Refreeze	90 s (Spec)
Nodes on the ice	Ice nodes can't be captured while their core panel is broken

The Sleeper's pulse (Spec): in Phase 4, a heartbeat shockwave every **60 s** cracks all lake ice at once. A deep thump 5 s ahead and a visible light pulse from beneath warn players. **Wildlife:** Frostfangs, Snowback Grazers, Rime Weavers, Rimeback Stags, Stiltwalkers, Drift Owlbears (2–3 drifts), Hoarfrost Mites (3–5 swarms). **Memory:** *The Seventh*: the planet growing a seventh answer, then stopping. **Weather:** Clear, Rime Fog, Breathing Night. **Horizon:** the Frozen Falls; the Drowsing One in an ice cave. **Stillheart note:** Hoarfrost Mites and the cold suit it, but the map was designed before Stillheart; it isn't listed as favoured.

10.3 Shard Reef (Shattered Coast)

Identity: a coastal front where the tide opens and closes parts of the map. **Favours:** Thornrunner and Brawler (causeway fights), Hollow (blinking across flooded ground).

Layout	Value
Orientation	Bases north and south on the clifftops above the tide; mirror z = 0
The Shard Reef	A reef of singing meteor glass in the centre; **The Singing Reef** Hub on it
Causeways	**Three causeways** (west, centre, east) link the reef to the shore, each 12 m wide, flooding at high tide
Crater zone	**The Glittering Shallows** (east flank in `gdd/16`; on the mirror line at (140, 0))
Heartwood grove	**Kelp Root** (west, (−140, 0)), where the planet's roots reach the sea
Breaker's Steps	Fist-shaped craters down the cliffs; a vertical descent route on each side

The tide (Spec rule, Proposal detail)

Rule	Value
Cycle	Every **3 min** the tide comes in for **60 s** (Spec)
Warning	15 s: waves grow, Shoal-lights scatter, the HUD shows a tide timer
Flooding	Two low-lying nodes on each side and all three causeways become **Inaccessible**; standing in flood water: −40% speed
Tidal Striders	2–3 walk the flooded causeways; players beneath are hidden (r 4 m)
Low tide	**Tide pools** appear with small core caches (Proposal: 4 pools per side, 30 cores each)
The reef at high tide	Reachable only by Hollow Step, Tidal Strider cover (wading) or by holding position when it floods

Stillsong Whales: a Planet Pulse event unique to this map; whale song stops Blight spreading within 60 m for 20 s. **Wildlife:** Tide Scuttlers, Tidecrawlers, Strider Cranes, Shard Gulls (Gull Cliffs), Shoal-lights (ambient). **Memory sites:** *The Breaker's Stand* (the cracked cliffs) and *The Deep Swallows* (the Deepmaw rising). **Lore note (Spec):** the coast *looks* half-blighted (cyan-violet water, shard cliffs), but both teams start equal. **Weather:** Clear, Shard Storm, Rime Fog. **Horizon:** the Last Bellow on a distant cliff.

10.4 The Nerve (Underroot)

Identity: a three-level cave map along the planet's nerves, where light gives you away. **Favours:** Hollow (blink between levels), Thornrunner (ambush), Stillheart (holding chokepoints).

Layout	Value
Levels	**Upper, Middle, Deep**, 14 m apart, linked by root-ramps (walkable) and drop-shafts (one-way)
Central Hub	**The Knot** on the Middle level, where nerve-roots meet
Bases	Deep caverns on the third (Deep) level, lit by nerve-light
Crater zone	**The Blight Pocket** (Murmur crept in through the tunnels)
Heartwood grove	**The Root Tendril**, a strand of the First Root reaching up from below
Nodes	Every level has nodes (vertical-map rule): ~10 per level

Nerve pulses (Spec): every **20 s**, a wave of amber light runs along the nerve-roots; any player in a **corridor** when it passes is **revealed for 2 s**. Chambers are safe. Telegraph: the roots brighten 2 s ahead with a rising hum. **Wildlife:** Lantern Lizards, Glow Lizards, Glasslegs, Burrowtusks (new tunnels mid-match), Lanternmoss. **Apex:** the **Sixfold Wyrm**, which tunnels between levels. **Memory:** *The Quiet Descends* (the Hollow First Answer sealing the deep places). **Vertical rules (`gdd/42`):** the minimap shows levels; falls cost time, not Health; Stage 3s can reach every level; footsteps above and below sound different.

10.5 The Skull Basin (2v2, Brood Skirmish)

Identity: a small circular arena inside the eye socket of a skull so large its rim is a cliff.

Rule	Value
Size	About **160 m** across
Nodes	**10**
Hubs	**1**: the **Iris**, a raised bone disc in the centre that overlooks the whole basin
Enemy Cores	1 per team
Flank zones	Small patches either side of the Iris
Symmetry	**Rotational** (the flank patches sit either side of the centre, so rotation works here)
The rim	Climbable on Bonevine at **4 points**; high ground exposed from both sides

Bone-fall (Spec): every **2 min**, a chunk of the rim breaks off and crashes into the basin at a **telegraphed** spot (a shadow and falling grit for 5 s, Proposal), dealing 300 damage in a 6 m radius and leaving permanent new cover. **Wildlife:** Marrowhounds, one Trundleback (climbable cover). **Mode rules:** EXP ×2; matches end around Level 15–18.

10.6 The Ash Sea (Ashen Steppe)

Identity: a dune field of grey ash where **the terrain changes every phase**. **Favours:** Thornrunner and Hollow (dunes hide them), Bonespire (when the dunes open a sightline).

Rule	Value
Dune shift	At the start of each phase, the wind rises for **20 s** and the dunes **move** (Spec)
What moves	Dunes (5–12 m tall) shift 20–40 m; **nodes never move**, paths between them do
Fairness	Each shift is mirrored across the map's symmetry; both teams get the same change
Telegraph	A visible storm front rolls across the map (a grey wall); visibility drops to 10 m inside it
Buried things	Shifts uncover Starshard veins and fossil caches and bury others
Default weather	Ashfall (sight 18 m; sound carries farther)
Crater zone	A half-buried meteor shard that rises out of the ash as the dunes move
Heartwood grove	An old root breaking through the ash
Wildlife	Gravel Skinks, Spurlarks, Ashfangs, Clashhorn Beetles, a Stiltwalker herd
Apex	The **Hive Colossus**, crossing the dunes in Phase 3

Rule	Value
Risk	Changing terrain can feel random; it must be telegraphed and identical for both teams

Production: four pre-authored dune layouts (one per phase), blended during the 20 s storm, so navigation and sightlines are tested in advance; nothing is procedural at runtime.

10.7 The Glass Forest (Cinderveil / Glasswaste)

Identity: a burnt forest where natural obsidian and Murmur Blight stand side by side, and players have to read the difference. **Favours:** Thornrunner (trunks), Verdant (the living tree grove).

Safeguard (Spec)	Rule
Obsidian is scenery; Blight is territory	Obsidian is never capturable or part of the node system
Blight always glows; obsidian never does	Blight pulses cyan-violet; obsidian is dull black with a faint red heat-glow from below
Sound differs	Blight whispers; obsidian ticks and creaks as it cools
UI never ambiguous	Minimap and HUD always use team colours

Heat vents (Spec): cracks that pulse heat every **30 s**, damaging anyone on them (Proposal: 60 damage, 1 s), and briefly light the obsidian red, which makes everything easier to read. **Crater zone:** where the Glasswaste creeps into the forest. **Grove:** a single living tree with green shoots. **Memory:** *The Fever Meets the Glass*. **Wildlife:** Cinderfangs, Cinder Salamanders, Ash Vultures, Glass Weavers. **Horizon:** the Rootless walking the edge.

10.8 The Weaver's Hollow (Rootwilds, proposal)

Identity: a vertical map fought on web-bridges strung across a deep forested valley. **Favours:** Thornrunner (fast on strands), Verdant (canopy nodes), Bonespire (long views).

Rule	Value
Levels	Forest floor, canopy, and the web itself
Web-bridges	Strands 3–5 m wide link the treetops; anyone can walk them
Cutting	Any strand can be **cut (8 s channel) or burned**; anyone on it drops to the level below (no damage)
Regrowth	Cut strands regrow after **90 s**
The Weavemother	Neutral Tier III at the web's centre; disturbing her makes her attack the closest player
Crater zone	East: a fallen shard caught in the web, glazing the strands
Grove	West: the Mother Oak, whose hollow is a sheltered node
Dawn	The web glows, lighting the valley

10.9 The Heron Reach (Hollow Mire, 2v2 proposal)

Identity: a shallow lake where stealth is almost impossible. **Favours:** Hollow, Stillheart.

Rule	Value
The flock	Thousands of Strider Cranes; any fight or fast movement in the open startles a section, revealing the players beneath it for **5 s**
Reed islands	Whisperreed islands give the only cover
Fogwell	A warm spring in the centre pours fog every **2 min**, hiding everything for ~10 s: the only safe time to move fast

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10.10 The Frozen Falls (Rimewastes, proposal)

Identity: a cliff map around a waterfall frozen mid-fall. Built to fill the Stillheart gap. **Favours:** Stillheart (cold, chokepoints), Titan (breaking ice), Bonespire (high ground).

Rule	Value
The falls	Divide the map vertically; marked climbing routes give a fast, exposed path

Rule	Value
	up
Breakable ice	Heavy hits crack the falls, opening shortcuts or dropping climbers
The pool below	Unfrozen: falling in slows and damages, as on The Sleeper
Snow Halls	Caves where Drift Owlbears sleep
Crater zone	Rimeglass on the upper plateau
Grove	A Warm Spring at the base

10.11 Lineage balance across all 13 maps (Spec, `gdd/42`)

Lineage	Maps that favour it
Titan	Elder Ribs, Fevermouth, Skull Basin, Frozen Falls (4)
Brawler	Elder Ribs, Fevermouth, Shard Reef, Skull Basin (4)
Verdant	Breathing Canopy, The Sleeper, Glass Forest, Weaver's Hollow (4)
Hollow	Breathing Canopy, The Sleeper, Shard Reef, The Nerve, Ash Sea, Heron Reach (6)
Thornrunner	Ashfall, Breathing Canopy, Fevermouth, Shard Reef, The Nerve, Ash Sea, Glass Forest, Weaver's Hollow (8)
Bonespire	Ashfall, Elder Ribs, The Sleeper, Ash Sea, Weaver's Hollow, Frozen Falls (6)
Stillheart	The Nerve, Heron Reach, Frozen Falls (3)

Watch: Thornrunner is favoured most often. New maps should avoid adding Thornrunner advantages and favour Titan, Brawler or Stillheart.

10.12 The map pipeline (Spec, `gdd/42`)

1. Landmark chosen for its silhouette, story and gameplay idea.
2. One-page concept: identity, signature mechanic, lineages favoured.
3. Greybox following the map rules (§8.1).
4. Balance check: both bases equal; flank zones equidistant; every lineage has somewhere to shine.
5. Art pass: region palette, horizon landmarks, flora and wildlife.
6. Audio pass: soundscape, signature sounds, the region motif.
7. Memory sites placed.
8. Season fit: which season and Turn it launches in.

Part 11 — World Systems

The systems that change a map while a match is running: phases, weather, time of day, the Turns, Tension events, hazards and sound. Numbers are **Spec** unless marked.

11.1 Match phases (Spec, `gdd/06`)

#	Phase	Time (Standard)	Short match (Built default: ×0.5)	What switches on
1	Stable Flow	0:00–5:00	0:00–2:30	Spread out, root nearby nodes, lineages awaken
2	Pre-Aggro Resource Control	5:00–10:00	2:30–5:00	Hub fights; Enemy Cores attackable; Tension starts building
3	Resource Stage	10:00–16:00	5:00–8:00	Hub Defense race; events fire; Tier IV spawns; the central Hub's roots permanently Exposed. Synergy S1 locked, S2 31 s, S3 20 s
4	Hunt	16:00–end	8:00–end	Every node next to a base becomes Vulnerable; Base Hearts attackable; S1 and S2 locked, S3 9 s; respawn +5 s

Phase scaling for wildlife: Health and damage ×1.00 / 1.15 / 1.30 / 1.45. **Announcements:** each phase change has a map-wide sound (a wooden horn for Wildborn, a glass chime for Blightborn; Built) and a HUD banner.

11.2 Visibility (Spec, `spec/01`)

Condition	Sight radius
Base	30 m (Stage 3: 40 m)
Night	22 m (Stage 3: 30 m)
Ashfall	18 m
Rime Fog	15 m
Revealed	Visible to the revealing team through fog and terrain for the duration
Carriers of 300+ cores	Shown on the enemy minimap every 5 s
Minimap	Teammates always; enemies only when visible or pinged

Built: enemies outside the team's sight are hidden; 300+ carriers always shown.

11.3 Weather

Weather	Visual (`gdd/23`)	Gameplay (Proposal unless Spec)	Maps
Clear	Soft daylight; full palette	Normal sight. Elder Ribs: salt glare at noon	All
Ashfall	Grey particles drifting diagonally; distant shapes become silhouettes	Sight 18 m (Spec); footsteps heard ×1.3 farther	Ashfall Crossing, Fevermouth, Ash Sea
Rime Fog	Low white fog; creature tops visible above it; frost everywhere	Sight 15 m (Spec); Base Forms and Stage 1 hidden in the fog layer beyond 10 m	Breathing Canopy, The Sleeper, Shard Reef
Sap Rain	Warm amber droplets; glossy wet surfaces	SAP income +10% for both teams; footsteps ×0.8	Breathing Canopy
Shard Storm	Glittering glass streaks; cyan flashes where shards land	Random shard strikes: a 2 m decal 1.0 s ahead, 60 damage; sight 22 m	Elder Ribs, Shard Reef
Breathing Night	Darkness lit by the Lantern moon, the Fall-line and every living glow	Night sight (22 m); glows (weak points, carriers) read from farther	Ashfall, Elder Ribs, Breathing Canopy, The Sleeper

Rule: weather never hides team outlines or weak points. One weather per match, chosen at random from the map's pool and shown on the loading screen.

11.4 Time of day (Proposal)

Each match plays one day-cycle segment, chosen per match: dawn → day, day → dusk, or dusk → night. The segment lasts the whole match, so light changes slowly and fairly for both sides.

Time	Light	Mood
Dawn	Low, soft, grey-gold through mist	Calm, waking
Day	Diffuse light from the Grey Eye; soft shadows	Clear, readable
Dusk	Warm gold fading to violet; long shadows; the Fall-line starts to glow	Most atmospheric

Time	Light	Mood
Night	The Lantern moon's amber, the Fall-line's cyan-violet, and gameplay glows	Mysterious; glow is the main light

Rule: night must stay readable; ambient light never drops so low that silhouettes are lost.

11.5 The Turns (seasons of the planet's year)

Turn	Wildlife (Spec, `spec/04`)	World look
Bloom	+1 Tier I group per biome; Mossback Calves present; Lumen Bees active	Flowers on Verdants and in Titans' moss; structures flower
Ash	Ash Vultures ×2; Ashfang packs of 4	A coat of ash on every creature and surface
Rime	All wildlife −10% speed; Hoarfrost Mites swarm; Drift Owlbears in deep sleep (wake radius 1.5 m)	Frost on fur, bark and glass; breath visible; birth-pools steam
Fever	Predators +10% damage; Cinder Salamanders on every lava map	Heat shimmer; bark parched; glass glows warmer

Turn overlays are cosmetic on creatures and never hide weak points or change silhouettes.

11.6 Tension and global events (Spec, `spec/05` §8)

Rule	Value
Regions	5 per standard map (one per Hub)
Range	0–100 per region
Builds from	Phase 2; events fire from Phase 3
At 100	An event fires in that region; Tension resets; region cooldown 90 s
Global limit	One event at a time; at most one every 60 s

Factor	Tension per second
Borders touching in the region	+0.2
Each fight within 15 m of a border	+1.0
Stage 2 creature nearby	×1.5 on its fight's rate
Stage 3 creature nearby	×2
The Old Tall within 30 m	×3 on everything
No fighting for 30 s	−0.5 (decay)

Audio cue (Spec): a low drone begins at 75 Tension in that region.

Deck	When	Events (weight · duration · effect)
Neutral	TI within 5%	Rootquake (25% · 30 s · all nodes in the region Vulnerable) · Marrow Storm (20% · 20 s · weak points exposed from any angle) · Stampede (20% · 30 s · staggers +50%, Momentum ×2) · SAP Surge (20% · first team to spend 200 SAP gets ×3 SAP for 60 s) · Core Bloom (15% · 400 loose cores at the region's centre)
Planet Pulse	Wildborn behind by > 5% (60%, else neutral)	Heartquake (40% · 20 s · Blightborn nodes Vulnerable, uproot at half time) · Healing Bloom (40% · 15 s · Wildborn regenerate 3%/s) · The Old Tall wakes (20% · 45 s · hunts Blightborn)
Murmur Surge	Blightborn behind by > 5% (60%, else neutral)	Shard Rain (40% · 15 s · 150/s to Wildborn structures, final) · Thousand Whispers (40% · 10 s · all Wildborn revealed map-wide) · Blighted Wyrm (20% · 45 s · hunts Wildborn)

Event resource gain: where an event pays out, each team's share is boosted +1% per cell it holds in that region, max +30%.

Event presentation (Proposal)

Event	Warning	Visual	Audio
Rootquake	3 s ground tremor	Ground heaves; roots and Glaze tear loose	Deep groan
Marrow Storm	Bone dust rises	Wind full of bone dust; every weak point glows through it	Howling wind, clicking bone
Stampede	Herds bellow	Every herd in the region bolts	Thundering hooves
SAP Surge	A geyser cracks open	An amber geyser; the claiming team's colour rings it	A rush like a fountain
Core Bloom	Light pulses from the ground	400 cores burst up and scatter	A rising chime
Heartquake	The planet's heartbeat	Blight cracks open in the region	A deep heartbeat felt in the controller

Event	Warning	Visual	Audio
Healing Bloom	Petals fall	Amber flowers bloom under Wildborn	Soft choral swell
Shard Rain	Glitter in the sky	Shards fall on Wildborn structures (decals 1.0 s ahead)	Glass whistling, then shattering
Thousand Whispers	Whispers rise	Every Wildborn outlined in violet for Blightborn	A rising chorus of whispers

11.7 Map hazards (summary)

Hazard	Map	Damage / effect	Warning
Grey Migration	Ashfall Crossing	40/s on the road; pushed off	20 s
Shard storm (crater)	Ashfall Crossing (Shardfall Hollow)	12/s outside cover; sight 15 m	10 s
Grasping ground	Heartwood groves	Root 0.8 s after 1.5 s still	Twitching roots
Salt glare	Elder Ribs	Sight 22 m toward the sun at noon	Always visible
Canopy fall	Breathing Canopy	Sight 18 m under the canopy	5 s exhale
Mud	Hollow Mire areas	−20% speed (Spec)	Visible
Eruption	Fevermouth	80/s in lava; cells uncapturable 60 s	20 s
Embergrass fire	Fevermouth	20/s; spreads 1 m/s for 10 s	Ignition visible
Breaking ice	The Sleeper, Frozen Falls	Water: −40% speed, 2% max Health/s	Cracks visible
Sleeper's pulse	The Sleeper (Phase 4)	All lake ice cracks	5 s thump
Tide	Shard Reef	Nodes Inaccessible; water −40% speed	15 s
Nerve pulse	The Nerve	Revealed 2 s in corridors	2 s glow
Bone-fall	The Skull Basin	300 in r 6 m; new cover	5 s shadow
Dune shift	The Ash Sea	Routes change; sight 10 m in the storm	Visible storm front
Heat vent	The Glass Forest	60 per pulse	Pulses every 30 s

11.8 Sound as a gameplay system

Sound signatures (Spec, `gdd/03`)

Factor	Effect
Stage	Bigger Ascendants are louder and heard from farther
Carrying 150+ cores	Footsteps and aura audible from farther
Carrying 300+	Shown on the enemy minimap every 5 s
Hollow	No footstep sounds
Thornrunner	Footsteps ×0.5 range
Stillheart	Footsteps ×0.7 range
Hush Cicadas	Mute signatures within 15 m
The Roar	Maxes every signature within 30 m

Hearing distances (Proposal)

Source	Heard from
Base Form footsteps	12 m
Stage 1 footsteps	18 m
Stage 2 footsteps	30 m (Titan: through walls)
Stage 3 footsteps	45 m
Carry aura 150+	+10 m
Spire Lance crack	60 m (Spec)
Transformation	Map-wide (Spec)
Tier IV footsteps	60 m
Enemy Core under attack	Owning team, map-wide, quiet (Spec)

Accessibility (Spec principle, `gdd/19`, `gdd/43`)

Every sound cue that carries information has a visual equivalent:

Cue	Visual equivalent
Footsteps and carry auras	Directional sound indicators at the screen edge
Wildlife reactions (birds silent, prey fleeing)	Optional small icon over the region
Tension drone	Region tint on the minimap at 75+

Cue	Visual equivalent
Phase horns and chimes	HUD banner
The Unspoken's whispers	Directional whisper indicators (required)
Low-Health breathing	Vignette pulse

11.9 Colour-blind palettes (Spec, `gdd/23`)

Palette	Wildborn	Blightborn	Team outlines
Default	Amber	Cyan-violet	Gold / red
Deuteranopia	Orange-yellow	Deep blue	White / magenta
Protanopia	Yellow	Blue	White / orange
Tritanopia	Red-orange	Teal	White / pink

Material (matte organic vs. glossy crystal vs. crusted Scald) carries the side even without colour. **Built:** a colour-blind team-colour option (blue / orange) exists in Settings.

11.10 Open questions for the director

These came up while writing this document and need a decision before greybox:

1. **Mirror vs. rotational symmetry** (§8.1): adopt mirror symmetry for maps whose flank zones sit on the centre line? The build already uses it.
2. **Ashfall Crossing size:** keep the tested 280 × 180 m core and expand only the flanks (proposal: 320 × 240 m), or rebuild at the GDD's 320 × 320 m?
3. **Wildlife counts on Ashfall Crossing:** approve the additions in §8.2 that bring it inside the Spec ranges?
4. **Blighted forms for the four Season 4 creatures** (Part 6, rows 43–46): approve the proposals?
5. **Balance sign-off** on the playtest overrides (Base Heart 12,000, Enemy Core reward 900, SAP 0.1/cell, EXP and bounty curves), still pending from `sim/findings.md`.